Doutorado em Matemática - IMPA

LECTURE NOTES ON ERGODIC THEORY

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1 Dynamical Systems

In this course we shall deal with *autonomous deterministic dynamical systems.* They can be used to represent or modelize any phenomenon that changes along the time in such a way that the current state of the system completely determines the future evolution and the law that drives this evolution does not change along the time. Mathematically, an **autonomous deterministic dynamical system** (a **dynamical system**, for short) is given by a set M, usually called the **phase space,** which represents the set of possible states of the system, a subsemigroup $\mathbb{T} \subset \mathbb{R}$ that represents the **time set,** and *"a law"* $\Phi\colon \mathbb{T} \times M \to M$ that determines the evolution of the system in such a way that given the current state of our system $x_0 \in M$, at time $t \in \mathbb{T}$ the corresponding state will be $x_t = \Phi(x_0, t)$. The autonomy of the system is reflected in the so called **flow** (or **semi-flow**) condition function Φ satisfies:

$$\Phi(t+s, x) = \Phi\big(t, \Phi(s,x)\big) = \Phi\big(t, \Phi(s,x)\big), \quad \forall t, s \in \mathbb{T},\ \forall x \in M. \tag{1}$$

We will consider two different kinds of dynamical systems: **discrete time** and **continuous time** ones, i.e. where $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{N}_0$ and $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}_{\geqslant 0}$, respectively. Moreover, we will also consider **invertible systems** where the current state of the systems does not just determine the future but the past as well. When dealing with invertible discrete dynamical systems, the time set will be $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{Z}$, and in the case of invertible continuous time ones, we will have $\mathbb{T} = \mathbb{R}$.

The main goal of Dynamical Systems consists in describing the **asymptotic behavior of the orbits of the systems,** i.e. the sets

$$\mathcal{O}_\Phi(x) := \{\Phi(t,x) : t \in \mathbb{T}\}, \quad \forall x \in M.$$

Exercise 1.1 (Discrete time generator)**.** Given a discrete time dynamical system $\Phi\colon \mathbb{T} \times M \to M$, show that Φ satisfies the flow condition (1) if and only if there is $f\colon M \circlearrowleft$ such that

$$\Phi(n, x) = f^n(x), \quad \forall x \in M,\ \forall n \in \mathbb{N}_0,$$

where the iteration of f is inductively defined by $f^0 := id_M$ and $f^{n+1} = f \circ f^n$, for every $n \geqslant 0$. Show that Φ is invertible if and only if f is bijective and, in such a case, one can define $f^{-n} := \big(f^{-1}\big)^n$, for all $n \geqslant 0$.

On the other hand, one can find *infinitesimal generators* for continuous time smooth dynamical systems:

Exercise 1.2 (Continuous time generator)**.** Let M be a differentiable closed manifold (i.e. compact and boundaryless) and $\Phi\colon \mathbb{R}\times M\to M$ a continuous time dynamical system (that satisfies the flow condition 1). If we assume Φ is a C^2 map and we define $X(p) := \partial_t\Phi(t,p)\big|_{t=0} \in T_pM$, for every $p\in M$, then the function $\Phi(\cdot,x_0)\colon\mathbb{R}\to M$ is the unique solution of the *initial value problem*

$$\dot{x}(t) = X\big(x(t)\big), \quad x(0)=x_0,$$

for every $x_0\in M$. In other words, the vector field X is the infinitesimal generator of the flow Φ.

To give meaning to the expression *"asymptotic behavior"* it is necessary to endow dynamical systems with an additional structure that makes it possible to analyze the behavior of their orbits as time tends to infinity.

When the phase space M is a topological space and the semi-flow Φ is continuous, one can study the accumulation points of the orbits as time goes to infinity and this is the basic scenario of **topological dynamics.**

On the other hand, when $\Phi\colon\mathbb{T}\times M\to M$ is an arbitrary dynamical system, one can study the **statistical properties** the frequency of visits of the orbit of a certain point $x\in M$ to a subset $A\subset M$. This problem naturally lead us to consider **invariant measures** on M and this is one of the fundamental problems in **ergodic theory.**

1.1 The setup of Ergodic Theory

Ergodic theory can be roughly described as the study of **measure preserving dynamical systems.**

More precisely, by a **(discrete time) dynamical system** we mean a map $T\colon X\to X$, where X is its **phase space** and the dynamics is given by the iteration of T: $T^0 = id_X$ and $T^{n+1} := T\circ T^n$, for every $n\geqslant 0$. When T is bijective, one can consider the "past trajectories" taking negative iterates that are defined by $T^{-n} := (T^{-1})^n$, for every $n\geqslant 0$.

We say that $T\colon X\circlearrowleft$ is a **measurable** system when X is a endowed with a σ-algebra $\mathscr{B}\subset 2^X$ and T is a $\mathscr{B}$-measurable map, i.e. $T^{-1}(B)\in\mathscr{B}$, for every $B\in\mathscr{B}$.

When μ is a measure on the measurable space $(X,\mathscr{B})$ and $T\colon X\circlearrowleft$ is a measurable map, we say that T **preserves** μ, or that μ is a T**-invariant measure**, when it holds

$$\mu(A) = \mu\big(T^{-1}(A)\big), \quad \forall A\in\mathscr{B}.$$

So, a **measure preserving system** is the quadruple $T\colon(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\circlearrowleft$ where $T\colon X\circlearrowleft$ is a $\mathscr{B}$-measurable map and μ is a T-invariant **probability** measure, i.e. where $\mu(X)=1$.

Analogous concepts can be defined for continuous time dynamical systems, also called **semi-flows** and **flows**, and more generally, for (measurable) actions of semi-groups and groups.

Our main references for the course are the books of Viana and Oliveira [VO16] and Mañé [Mañ87].

1.2 Motivations

Let us see some fundamental problems in Dynamical Systems that motivate the study of invariant measures and their properties.

1.2.1 Dynamical systems with a natural invariant measure

There are many classical dynamical systems, which are used to model natural phenomena, that already arise with a "natural" invariant (finite) measure. From the historical point of view, one of the most important examples are Hamiltonian systems that are used to described the evolution of conservative systems in Classical Mechanics.

So, the first main question in ergodic theory could be briefly and roughly summarized as follows:

> *What dynamical information can be extracted from the fact that a dynamical system leaves invariant a certain measure?*

1.2.2 Statistical study of dynamical systems

A second motivation to study measure preserving systems comes from the analysis of *statistical aspects* of dynamical systems. In its simplest form, let us suppose a dynamical system $T\colon X \circlearrowleft$ is given and there is a point $x \in X$ such that *asymptotic visiting frequency function of* x is well defined for every $A \in 2^x := \{B \subset X\}$. More precisely, let us suppose that defining $\tau_x^{(n)}\colon 2^X \to [0,1]$ by

$$\tau_x^{(n)}(A) := \frac{\sharp\big\{0 \leqslant i \leqslant n-1 : T^i(x) \in A\big\}}{n}, \quad \forall A \subset X,\ \forall n \in \mathbb{N},$$

the following limit exists:

$$\tau_x(A) := \lim_{n \to +\infty} \tau_x^{(n)}(A), \quad \forall A \subset X.$$

Exercise 1.3. Show that $\tau_x\colon 2^X \to [0,1]$ is a finitely additive probability measure and it holds

$$\tau_x\big(T^{-1}(A)\big) = \tau_x(A), \quad \forall A \subset X.$$

Is τ_x σ-additive?

As we shall see along the course, in general it is not true that the asymptotic visiting frequency is well defined for every set A and different points xc an have different asymptotic visiting frequencies on the same set A. So, in order to study the statistical properties of a certain system it will be necessary to analyze the whole set of invariant measures.

1.2.3 Applications to combinatorics and number theory

As third motivation, we will see that ideas and techniques of ergodic theory can be applied to get some nice results on combinatorics and number theory. The main reference for this part of the course in the book of Einsiedler and Ward [EW11].

1.2.4 Normal numbers

A real number $x \in [0,1]$ is said to be *b-normal*, for $b \in \mathbb{N}$ and $b \geqslant 2$, when its digit in base b are uniformly distributed, i.e. given a sequence of integer numbers $(a_n)_{n\geqslant 1}$, with $0 \leqslant a_n \leqslant b-1$ such that

$$x = \sum_{n\geqslant 1} \frac{a_n}{b^n},$$

it holds

$$\lim_{n\to+\infty} \frac{\sharp\{i \in \mathbb{N} : i \leqslant n-1,\ a_i = a\}}{n} = \frac{1}{b},$$

for every $a \in \{0, 1, \ldots, b-1\}$.

Then we say that $x \in [0,1]$ is just *normal* when it is b-normal, for every $b \in \mathbb{N}$ with $b \geqslant 2$.

Using ergodic techniques one can prove that Lebesgue almost every point of $[0,1]$ is normal indeed.

1.2.5 Distribution of the first digit of 2^n

For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let us writ a_n for the first digit of the decimal representation of 2^n. We want to study the asymptotic distribution of the sequence (a_n) in the set $\{1, \ldots, 9\}$.

In this case, using ergodic tools again, one can show that

$$\frac{\sharp\{1 \leqslant j \leqslant n : a_j = k\}}{n} \to \log_{10}\left(\frac{k+1}{k}\right), \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty,$$

for each $k \in \{1, \ldots, 9\}$.

1.2.6 Existence of arithmetic progressions

One says the set $A \subset \mathbb{Z}$ has *positive upper density* when there are sequences of integer numbers (m_j) and (n_j) such that $m_j - n_j \to +\infty$, as $j \to +\infty$ and

$$\lim_{j\to+\infty} \frac{\sharp(A \cap [m_j, n_j])}{m_j - n_j} > 0.$$

Erdős and Turán proposed the following conjecture in [ET36]: Every subset of integer numbers with positive upper density contains arbitrarily long arithmetic progressions. This conjecture remained open for almost 40 years and it was finally proved by Szeméredi [Sze75] using rather complicated combinatorial arguments. Two years later, Furstenberg proposed in [Fur77] a purely ergodic proof of this result, opening the door to a long standing and fruitful interaction of Combinatorics and Ergodic Theory.

2 Measure theory and the setting of Ergodic theory

2.1 Measurable spaces

All along these notes, X will denote a non-empty set. We shall write 2^X for the set of subsets of X. A **σ-algebra** on X is a family $\mathcal{B} \subset 2^X$ such hat $\varnothing, X \in \mathcal{B}$ and given $A_1, A_2, \ldots \in \mathcal{B}$, it holds $\bigcup_{n\geqslant 1} A_n \in \mathcal{B}$. A **measurable space** is a pair $(X, \mathcal{B})$ where X is a non-empty set and $\mathcal{B}$ is a σ-algebra on X.

There is a natural partial order among σ-algebras of X given by set inclusion. Invoking this order, given any family $\mathcal{C} \subset 2^X$ one can define the **σ-algebra generated by $\mathcal{C}$**, which will be denoted by $\sigma(\mathcal{C})$, as the smallest σ-algebra that contains $\mathcal{C}$.

When X is a topological space and $\tau \subset 2^X$ is the topology of X, i.e. τ is the family of open subsets in X, the σ-algebra $\sigma(\tau)$ generated by τ is called the **Borel σ-algebra** of X is usually denoted by $\mathcal{B}(X)$.

Given a measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$, and an arbitrary map $f\colon X \to Y$, one can define the **push-forward σ-algebra** $f_\star\mathcal{B}$ on Y by

$$f_\star\mathcal{B} := \left\{E \subset Y : f^{-1}(E) \in \mathcal{B}\right\}. \tag{2}$$

On the other hand, given another map $h\colon Z \to X$, we defined the **pull-back σ-algebra** $f^\star\mathcal{B}$ on Z by

$$f^\star\mathcal{B} := \left\{E \subset Z : \exists A \in \mathscr{B},\ f^{-1}(A) = E\right\}. \tag{3}$$

Given two measurable spaces $(X, \mathcal{B})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{C})$, a map $f\colon X \to Y$ is said to be **measurable** when $\mathcal{C} \subset f_\star\mathcal{B}$.

Exercise 2.1. If $(X, \mathcal{B})$ and $(Y, \mathcal{C})$ are measurable spaces and $f\colon X \to Y$, show that $f^\star\mathcal{C} \subset \mathcal{B}$ if and only if $\mathcal{C} \subset f_\star\mathcal{B}$.

2.2 Measure spaces

A **measure** on a measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$ is map $\mu\colon \mathcal{B} \to [0, +\infty]$ such that $\mu(\varnothing) = 0$, $\mu(X) > 0$ and

$$\mu\Big(\bigsqcup_{n=1}^{\infty} A_n\Big) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu(A_n),$$

for every sequence of pairwise disjoint sets $A_1, A_2, \ldots \in \mathcal{B}$. The measure μ on $(X, \mathcal{B})$ is said to be **finite** when $\mu(X) < \infty$; a **probability** measure when $\mu(X) = 1$; and **σ-finite** when there exists a sequence $X_1, X_2, \ldots \in \mathcal{B}$ such that $\mu(X_n) < \infty$ for every $n \geqslant 1$ and $X = \bigcup_{n\geqslant 1} X_n$.

The triple $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is said to be a **measure space** when $(X, \mathscr{B})$ is a measurable space and μ is a measure on it. Given an arbitrary map $f\colon X \to Y$, where $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is a measure space, one can define the **push-forward measure** $f_\star\mu$ on the measurable space $(Y, f_\star\mathcal{B})$ by

$$f_\star\mu(A) := \mu\big(f^{-1}(A)\big), \quad \forall A \in f_\star\mathcal{B}. \tag{4}$$

Exercise 2.2. Let $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ be a measure space, $(Y, \mathcal{C})$ a measurable space and $f\colon X \to Y$ a measurable map. The it holds

$$\int_X \phi \circ f \, \mathrm{d}\mu = \int_Y \phi \, \mathrm{d} f_\star \mu,$$

for any measurable function $\phi\colon Y \to [0, \infty]$.

Given two measure spaces $(X_i, \mathcal{B}_i, \mu_i)$ for $i = 1, 2$, a **morphism of measure spaces** or a **measure preserving map** is map $f\colon (X_1, \mathcal{B}_1, \mu_1) \to (X_2, \mathcal{B}_2, \mu_2)$ where $f\colon X_1 \to X_2$ is a measurable map and $f_\star \mu_1\big|_{\mathcal{B}_2} = \mu_2$. We say that f is a **metric isomorphism** when there exists a measure preserving map $g\colon (X_2, \mathcal{B}_2, \mu_2) \to (X_1, \mathcal{B}_1, \mu_1)$ such that $g \circ f(x) = x$, for μ_1-almost every $x \in X_1$, and $f \circ g(y) = y$, for μ_2-almost every $y \in X_2$. In such a case, we say that f and g are **invertible maps** and the spaces $(X_1, \mathcal{B}_1, \mu_1)$ and $(X_2, \mathcal{B}_2, \mu_2)$ are said to be **isomorphic**.

2.3 Measure algebras

Given a measure space $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$, we say that two sets $A, B \in \mathcal{B}$ are **equal modulo** μ when $\mu(A \triangle B) = 0$, where $A \triangle B := (A \backslash B) \cup (B \backslash A)$.

One can easily check that the relation of equality modulo μ is an equivalence relation on $\mathcal{B}$. The set of equivalence classes will be denoted by $\widetilde{B} := \mathcal{B}/\!\sim$. Moreover, the set $\widetilde{\mathscr{B}}$ can be naturally endowed with Boolean algebra structure, defining the operations of union, intersection and complement on $\widetilde{\mathscr{B}}$ by

$$[A] \cup [B] := [A \cup B], \quad [A] \cap [B] := [A \cap B], \quad [A]^c := [A^c],$$

where $[A]$ denotes the equivalence class of $A \in \mathscr{B}$. The measure μ induces a measure $\tilde{\mu}$ on $\widetilde{\mathscr{B}}$ by $\tilde{\mu}([A]) := \mu(A)$, for every $A \in \mathscr{B}$. The **measure algebra** of $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is the pair $(\widetilde{\mathscr{B}}, \tilde{\mu})$. Observe that, when $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is finite measure space, one can define a distance $d_\mu\colon \widetilde{\mathscr{B}} \times \widetilde{\mathscr{B}} \to \mathbb{R}_{\geqslant 0}$ by

$$d_\mu([A], [B]) := \mu(A \triangle B), \quad \forall A, B \in \mathscr{B}.$$

Given two measure spaces $(X_i, \mathcal{B}_i, \mu_i)$ for $i = 1, 2$, we say that they are **conjugate** when there exists a Boolean algebra isomorphism $\Phi\colon \widetilde{\mathcal{B}}_1 \to \widetilde{\mathcal{B}}_2$ such that $\tilde{\mu}_2 \circ \Phi = \tilde{\mu}_1$.

Exercise 2.3. Show that if $(X_1, \mathcal{B}_1, \mu_1)$ and $(X_2, \mathcal{B}_2, \mu_2)$ are isomorphic measure spaces, then they are conjugate.
On the other hand, show that there exist conjugate measure spaces that are not isomorphic.

2.4 Borel and Lebesgue spaces

Given a topological space M, we write $\mathscr{B}_M$ for its **Borel σ-algebra** which is defined as the smallest σ-algebra containing every open subset.

A probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is said to be a **Borel space** when there is a compact metric space M and a Borel probability measure μ_M on $(M, \mathscr{B}_M)$ such that $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is isomorphic to $(M, \mathscr{B}_M, \mu_M)$.

In the literature, one can find the definition of Borel space as a probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ that is isomorphic to a Borel probability measure on a complete separable metric space. However, it is known that every Borel probability measure on a complete separable metric space is isomorphic to a Borel probability measure on a compact metric space; and Borel spaces are also called **standard spaces** or **regular spaces**.

The σ-algebra $\mathcal{B}_0^\mu \subset \mathcal{B}$ of **μ-null sets** is given by

$$\mathcal{B}_0^\mu := \{N \in \mathcal{B} : \mu(N) = 0\}.$$

We say that the measure space $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ is **complete** when for every $N \in \mathcal{B}_0^\mu$ and any $N' \subset N$, it holds $N \in \mathcal{B}$.

Every measure space $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ admits a unique **completion:** it is a complete metric space $(X, \overline{\mathcal{B}}, \bar{\mu})$ such that

$$\overline{\mathcal{B}} := \{B \cup N_1 \backslash N_2 : B \in \mathcal{B},\ \exists N \in \mathcal{B}_0^\mu,\ N_1, N_2 \subset N\},$$

and

$$\bar{\mu}(B \cup N_1 \backslash N_2) := \mu(B), \quad \forall B \in \mathcal{B},\ \forall N \in \mathcal{B}_0^\mu,\ \forall N_1, N_2 \subset N.$$

Observe that if $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is Borel space, then there exists a countable family $\mathcal{A} \subset \mathscr{B}$ such that $\sigma(\mathcal{A}) = \mathscr{B}$, i.e. the σ-algebra $\mathscr{B}$ is countably generated.

Finally, we say that the probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is a **Lebesgue space** when it is complete and is isomorphic to the completion of a Borel probability space. See [EW11, Appendix A. 6] for more details about Borel and Lebesgue spaces.

2.5 Smooth measures

Let M and N be a smooth manifolds, α be a k-form on N and $f\colon M \to N$ be a C^1 map. The **pullback** of α by f is the k-form $f^\star\alpha$ on M given by

$$f^\star\alpha(X_1, X_2, \dots, X_k) := \alpha\big(Df_x(X_1), Df_x(X_2), \dots, Df_x(X_k)\big),$$

for all $x \in M$, and every $X_1, \dots, X_k \in T_xM$.

On the other hand, given a complete smooth vector field X on the manifold M, we can consider the flow $\Phi_X\colon \mathbb{R} \times M \to M$ induced by X on M. We say that a Borel measure μ on M is X-invariant (or Φ_X-invariant) when it is Φ_X^t-invariant, for every $t \in \mathbb{R}$, where $\Phi_X^t(z) = \Phi_X(z, t)$, for every $z \in M$ and any $t \in \mathbb{R}$.

Then, given a smooth k-form α on M, one defines the *Lie derivative* of α with respect to X by

$$\mathcal{L}_X\alpha := \lim_{t\to 0} \frac{\big(\Phi_X^t\big)^\star\alpha - \alpha}{t}. \tag{5}$$

Now, given M a compact oriented smooth d-manifold M, a d-form ω is said to be **volume form**, when for every $x \in M$ and every positively oriented basis $\{X_1, X_2, \dots, X_d\}$ of the tangent space T_xM, it holds $\omega_x(X_1, \dots, X_d) > 0$.

Then, we can define the continuous linear functional $\Lambda_\omega \colon C^\infty(M,\mathbb{R}) \to \mathbb{R}$ by

$$\Lambda_\omega(\phi) := \int \phi\omega, \quad \forall \phi \in C^\infty(M,\mathbb{R}).$$

One can easily check that Λ_ω can be uniquely extended to a continuous linear functional $\overline{\Lambda_\omega} \colon C^0(M,\mathbb{R}) \to \mathbb{R}$, and by Riesz' representation theorem we conclude that there exists a finite Borel measure μ_ω such that

$$\overline{\Lambda_\omega}(\phi) = \int_M \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu_\omega, \quad \forall \phi \in C^0(M,\mathbb{R}).$$

The measure μ_ω is said to be a **smooth measure.**

Exercise 2.4. Given a C^1-map $f \colon M \circlearrowleft$, show that the smooth measure μ_ω is f-invariant if and only if $f^\star\omega = \omega$.
On the other hand, given a vector field X on M, show that μ_ϕ os X-invariant if and only if $\mathcal{L}_X\omega \equiv 0$.

Exercise 2.5. Can we define smooth measures on non-compact oriented manifolds? Can smooth measures be finite on non-compact manifolds? Smooth measures can be defined on non-orientable manifolds?

2.6 Some important exercises from [VO16, §1.1.1]

1.1.2, 1.1.3, 1.1.4, 1.1.5.

3 Recurrence on finite measure spaces

In this section we shall analyze the fact that finiteness of invariant measures imposes recurrence of the dynamical system.

Our first result is the celebrated

Theorem 3.1 (Poincaré recurrence theorem)**.** Let $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon (X, \mathcal{B}, \mu) \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map. Let $A \in \mathscr{B}$ be a measurable set such that $\mu(A) > 0$. Then, there exists $n \geqslant 1$ such that

$$\mu\big(A \cap f^{-n}(A)\big) > 0.$$

Proof. Let us suppose that $A, f^{-1}(A), f^{-2}(A), \dots$ are essentially disjoint, i.e. suppose that

$$\mu\big(f^{-i}(A) \cap f^{-j}(A)\big) = 0, \quad \forall i, j \in \mathbb{N}_0,\ i \neq j. \tag{6}$$

Let us define the sets $A_0 := A$, and $A_n := f^{-n}(A) \backslash \Big(\bigcup_{i=0}^{n-1} f^{-i}(A) \Big)$, for every $n \geqslant 1$. Then, the sets $A_0, A_1, A_2, \dots$ are pairwise disjoint, and by (6), we have

$$\mu\big(f^{-n}(A)\big) \geqslant \mu(A_n) \geqslant \mu(f^{-n}(A)) - \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \mu\big(f^{-n}(A) \cap f^{-i}(A)\big) = \mu\big(f^{-n}(A)\big),$$

for every $n \geqslant 1$, and hence it holds $\mu\big(f^{-n}(A)\big) = \mu(A_n)$, for any $n \geqslant 0$. Since μ is f-invariant, this implies $\mu(A_n) = \mu(A) > 0$, for every $n \geqslant 0$, getting a contradiction because

$$1 = \mu(X) \geqslant \mu\Big(\bigsqcup_{i=0}^{\infty} A_n \Big) = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \mu(A_n) = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} \mu(A) = \infty.$$

So, assumption (6) does not hold and hence, there exist $i, j \in \mathbb{N}$, with $i < j$ such that

$$0 < \mu\big(f^{-i}(A) \cap f^{-j}(A)\big) = \mu\Big(f^{-i}\big(A \cap f^{i-j}(A)\big)\Big) = \mu(A \cap f^{-(j-i)}(A)).$$

□

There are a lot of important results that can be proven as a consequence of Theorem 3.1. The firs one is indeed a very simple improvement of Theorem 3.1:

Corollary 3.2. Let $f\colon (X, \mathcal{B}, \mu) \circlearrowleft$ and $A \in \mathcal{B}$ be as in Theorem 3.1. Then, there is a natural number $n \leqslant \frac{1}{\mu(A)}$ such that

$$\mu\big(A \cap f^{-n}(A)\big) > 0.$$

Exercise 3.1. Prove Corollary 3.2.

Corollary 3.3. Let $f\colon (X,\mathcal{B},\mu) \circlearrowleft$ and $A \in \mathcal{B}$ as in Theorem 3.1. Then the set

$$A_f := \{x \in A : \exists n \geqslant 1,\ f^n(x) \in A\}$$

belongs to $\mathcal{B}$ and $\mu(A \backslash A_f) = 0$.

Proof. First notice that

$$A_f = \bigcup_{n\geqslant 1} \big(A \cap f^{-n}(A)\big).$$

So, $A_f \in \mathcal{B}$.

Then, let us define $A' := A\backslash A_f$. Observe that $A' \cap f^{-n}(A') = \varnothing$, for every $n \geqslant 1$. Hence, we have that $f^{-m}(A') \cap f^{-n}(A') = \varnothing$, whenever $0 \leqslant m < n$. By Theorem 3.1, we conclude that $\mu(A') = 0$. □

Then notice that Corollary 3.3 can be considerably improved:

Corollary 3.4. Let $f\colon (X,\mathcal{B},\mu) \circlearrowleft$ and $A \in \mathcal{B}$ as in Theorem 3.1. Then the set

$$A_\infty := \{x \in A : \exists n_j \uparrow \infty,\ f^{n_j}(x) \in A, \forall j \geqslant 1\}$$

belongs to $\mathcal{B}$ and $\mu(A \backslash A_\infty) = 0$.

Exercise 3.2. Prove Corollary 3.4.

3.1 Topological recurrence

Let X be a topological space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be an arbitrary map. We say that a point $x_0 \in X$ is **recurrent** for f when given any neighborhood V of x_0, there is a natural number $n \geqslant 1$ such that $f^n(x_0) \in V$.

Recall that a **base** for the topology of X is a family of open subsets $\mathcal{V}$ such that every open subset of X can be writte as the union of elements of $\mathcal{V}$.

Then we have the following topological version of Poincaré recurrence theorem:

Theorem 3.5. Let X be a topological space admitting a countable base for its topology and let $\mathcal{B}(X)$ denote its Borel σ-algebra. Let μ be a Borel probability measure on X (i.e. a probability measure on $\big(X,\mathcal{B}(X)\big)$ and $f\colon (X,\mathcal{B}(X),\mu) \circlearrowleft$ a measure preserving transformation. Then, μ-almost every point is recurrent for f.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{U} := \{U_n : n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ be a base for the topology of X. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ let us consider the set $W_n := \{x \in U_n : f^k(x) \notin U_n,\ \forall k \geqslant 1\}$. By Corollary 3.3 we know that $\mu(W_n) = 0$, for every $n \geqslant 1$. Hence, if we write $W := \bigcup_{n\geqslant 1} W_n$, we have $\mu(W) = 0$. Then we claim that every point in $X\backslash W$ is recurrent for f. In fact, let x an arbitrary point of $X\backslash W$ and V any neighborhood of x. Since $\mathcal{U}$ is a base for the topology of X, there is a natural number n such that $x \in U_n \subset V$. Since $x \notin W$, we have $x \notin W_n$ and then, there is $k \geqslant 1$ such that

$f^k(x) \in U_n \subset V$. Since V was an arbitrary neighborhood, we conclude x is recurrent for f, as desired. □

It is worth to recall at this point the following result due to Brikhoff:

Theorem 3.6 (Birkhoff recurrence theorem)**.** Let (X, d) be a compact metric space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a continuous map. Then, there exists a recurrent point for f.

Proof. Let us write $\mathcal{K}_f := \{K \subset X : K \text{ is compact, } K \neq \varnothing,\ f(K) \subset K\}$. Then, $\mathcal{K}_f$ is clearly non-empty because $X \in \mathcal{K}_f$. On the other hand, if we consider the partial order relation $\subset$ given by inclusion, any totally ordered family of elements in $\mathcal{K}_f$ admits a lower bound in $\mathcal{K}_f$ which is given by the intersection of all the elements of the totally ordered family.

So, as a consequence of Zorn's lemma, there is a minimal element M in $\mathcal{K}_f$ with respect to the partial order $\subset$. One can easily check that given any $x \in M$, by minimality, its positive semi-orbit $\mathcal{O}_f^+(x) := \{f^n(x) : n \geqslant 0\}$ is dense in M, and consequently, x is recurrent. □

3.2 Some important exercises from [VO16, §1.2.4]

1.2.2, 1.2.3, 1.2.5, 1.2.6.

4 Some examples of measure preserving transformations

4.1 Periodic orbits

Let X be an arbitrary set and $z \in X$ an arbitrary point. Then we can define the δ_z on the measurable space $(X, 2^X)$ by

$$\delta_z(A) := \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if } z \in A; \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Now, if $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ is any map and there exists $p \in X$ which is **periodic** for f, i.e. there exists $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $f^k(z) = z$, then the **periodic measure**

$$\nu_p := \frac{1}{k} \sum_{j=0}^{k-1} \delta_{f^j(p)} = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{j=0}^{k-1} f_\star^j \delta_p$$

is f-invariant.

4.1.1 Homeomorphisms of the interval

Using periodic measures and Poincare's recurrence theorem (Theorem 3.5) one can easily determine all invariant measures for homeomorphisms of a compact interval... at least for homeomorphisms with finitely many periodic orbits.

In fact, if $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ denotes a compact interval and $f\colon I \circlearrowleft$ is an orientation-preserving homeomorphism (i.e. f is an strictly increasing map), then one can easily show that $x \in I$ is a recurrent point for f if and only if $f(x) = x$, and moreover, the set of fixed points $\mathrm{Fix}(f) := \{w \in I : f(w) = w\}$ is non-empty.

On the other hand, if f is orientation-reversing, i.e. f is strictly decreasing, the $\mathrm{Fix}(f)$ has exactly one point and any other recurrent point is periodic of period 2.

In any case, if f has finitely many periodic orbits, by Theorem 3.5 one have that any f-invariant Borel probability measure is indeed a convex combination of periodic ones. What can we say about the characterization of f-invariant measures when f has infinitely many periodic orbits?

4.2 Expanding maps of the interval

Let $k \in \mathbb{N}$ be an arbitrary number and consider the map $f\colon [0,1] \circlearrowleft$ given by

$$f(x) := kx - \lfloor kx \rfloor, \quad \forall x \in [0,1]$$

where $\lfloor x \rfloor := \max\{\ell \in \mathbb{Z} : \ell \leqslant x\}$ denotes the *integer part* of x.

We claim that the Lebesgue measure m on $[0,1]$ is f-invariant. If $J \subset [0,1]$ is a subinterval, then one can easily check that $f_k^{-1}(J)$ is the disjoint union of k intervals $J_1, \ldots, J_k \subset [0,1]$ with $m(J_i) = \frac{1}{k} m(J)$, for each $i \in \{1, \ldots, k\}$. So, we conclude

$$m\big(f^{-1}(J)\big) = m\Big(\bigsqcup_{i=1}^{k} J_i\Big) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} m(J_i) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} \frac{1}{k} m(J) = m(J).$$

Thus, we have proved that the two probability measures m and $f_\star m$ coincide on the subintervals of $[0,1]$. In order to conclude that they are indeed the same, we invoke the following general result:

Theorem 4.1 (Uniqueness of measures, Theorem 5.7 in [Sch17])**.** Let μ and ν two measures on the measurable space $(X, \mathcal{B})$. Let $\mathscr{C} \subset 2^X$ be a family that generates $\mathcal{B}$, i.e. $\mathcal{B} = \sigma(\mathscr{C})$, and suppose that

- if $A, B \in \mathcal{C} \implies A \cap B \in \mathscr{C}$;
- there exists $(C_n)_{n\geqslant 1} \subset \mathscr{C}$ such that $C_n \uparrow X$ (i.e. $\bigcup_{n\geqslant 1} C_n = X$) with $\mu(C_n) = \nu(C_n) < \infty$, for every $n \geqslant 1$.

Then, $\mu = \nu$.

4.3 Bernoulli shifts

Let k be a natural number greater than 1 and consider the space

$$\Sigma_k^+ := \{1, \dots, k\}^{\mathbb{N}_0} = \{(i_0 i_1 i_2 \dots) : i_n \in \{1, \dots, k\},\ \forall n \geqslant 0\},$$

endowed with the product topology considering the discrete topology on each factor.

Then the so called *full shift* is the map $f\colon \Sigma_k^+ \circlearrowleft$ given by

$$f(i_0 i_1 i_2 \dots) := (i_1 i_2 i_3 \dots), \quad \forall (i_n) \in \Sigma_k^+.$$

Exercise 4.1. Show that the full shift map f is continuous and surjective and the set of periodic points

$$\mathrm{Per}(f) := \{x \in \Sigma_k^+ : \exists n \geqslant 1,\ f^n(x) = x\}$$

is dense in Σ_k^+. On the other hand, there is $x_0 \in \Sigma_k^+$ such that its orbit

$$\mathcal{O}_f^+(x_0) := \{f^n(x) : n \geqslant 0\}$$

is dense in Σ_k^+.

As a consequence of Exercise 4.1, we see that there are infinitely many periodic orbits. However, there is another important family of invariant measures for full shifts, usually called *Bernoulli measures.* In order to define them, let us considering an **stochastic vector** $\boldsymbol{p} = (p_1, p_2, \dots, p_k) \in \mathbb{R}^k$, i.e. $p_i \geqslant 0$ and $\sum_i p_i = 1$. Then, the **Bernoulli measure** induced by the stochastic vector $\boldsymbol{p}$ is the Borel probability measure μ on Σ_k^+ which is characterized by its values on *cylinders*: given a non-empty finite set $A \subset \mathbb{N}_0$ and a function $I\colon A \to \{1, \dots, k\}$, the *cylinder* $[A; I] \subset \Sigma_k^+$ is given by

$$[A; I] := \left\{(j_0 j_1 \dots) \in \Sigma_k^+ : j_n = I(n),\ \forall n \in A\right\}. \tag{7}$$

Then, the *Bernoulli measure* μ induced by $\boldsymbol{p}$ is characterized by its values on cylinders:

$$\mu[A; I] := \prod_{n \in A} p_{I(n)},$$

for every finite set $A \subset \mathbb{N}_0$ and every $I \in \{1, \dots, k\}^A$.

Exercise 4.2. Show that μ is a well-defined Borel probability measure and is f-invariant.

The space Σ_k^+ has interesting topological properties. A topological space X is said to be **totally disconnected** when given any pair of different points $x, y \in X$, there is an open and closed subset $A \subset X$ such that $x \in A$ and $y \in X \backslash A$. On the other hand, a point $x \in X$ is said to be an **isolated point** when the set $\{x\}$ is a neighborhood of x.

A **Cantor space** is a compact metric space which is totally disconnected and has no isolated points.

Exercise 4.3 (Construction of Cantor spaces)**.** Let $(X_n)_{n \geqslant 1}$ be a sequence of finite sets with $\sharp X_n \geqslant 2$, for every $n \geqslant 1$. Then, if we endow each set X_n with the discrete topology, the product space $\prod_{n \geqslant 1} X_n$ is a Cantor space.

Exercise 4.4 (Uniqueness of Cantor spaces)**.** Show that, up to homeomorphisms, there is only one Cantor space.

4.4 Circle rotations

Given any $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, one can define the map $T_\alpha \colon [0,1] \circlearrowleft$ by

$$T_\alpha(x) := x + \alpha - \lfloor x + \alpha \rfloor, \quad \forall x \in [0,1].$$

We claim that the Lebesgue measure m on $[0,1]$ is again T_α-invariant, for every $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$. In fact, it is enough to consider the case where $\alpha \in (0,1)$ and then, one can easily show that given $[a,b] \subset [0,1]$, it holds

$$\begin{aligned}
&T_\alpha^{-1}[a,b] = [a-\alpha, b-\alpha], \quad \text{when } \alpha \leqslant a \leqslant b \leqslant 1;\\
&T_\alpha^{-1}[a,b] = [a-\alpha+1, b-\alpha+1], \quad \text{when } 0 \leqslant a \leqslant b < \alpha;\\
&T_\alpha^{-1}[a,b] = [a-\alpha+1, 1) \cap [0, b-\alpha], \quad \text{when } 0 \leqslant a < \alpha \leqslant b \leqslant 1.
\end{aligned}$$

Circle rotations are particular examples of translations on compact groups.

4.5 Translations on locally compact groups

A **topological group** is a ternary $(G, \mathscr{T}, \cdot)$ where G is a non-empty set, $\mathscr{T}$ is a Hausdorff topology on G and $(G, \cdot)$ is group such that the map $G \times G \ni (g,h) \mapsto g \cdot h^{-1} \in G$ is a continuous map.

Analogously, a **Lie group** is a ternary $(G, \mathscr{C}, \cdot)$ where G is a non-empty set, $\mathscr{C}$ is a finite dimensional C^∞ Hausdorff structure on G, $(G, \cdot)$ is a group and the map $G \times G \ni (g, h) \mapsto g \cdot h^{-1} \in G$ is C^∞. Observe that any Lie group is a locally compact topological group.

Given topological group G and any element $g \in G$, one can define the **left and right translations** by $L_g \colon G \ni h \mapsto gh \in G$ and $R_g \colon G \ni h \mapsto hg^{-1} \in G$, respectively. Notice that L_g and R_g are homeomorphism on G; and when G is a Lie group, they are C^∞ diffeomorphisms.

Definition 4.1 (Haar measure)**.** Given a locally compact group G, a **(left) Haar measure** is a Radon measure μ on G (i.e. μ is Borel and $\mu(K) < \infty$, for every compact $K \subset G$) such that μ is L_g-invariant, for every $g \in G$, and there is a Borel set $E \subset G$ such that $\mu(E) > 0$.

Theorem 4.2 (Existence and characterization of Haar measures)**.** If G is locally compact group, then there exists a left Haar measure μ_G. The support of μ_G is G (i.e. $\mu_G(U) > 0$, for every non-empty open subset $U \subset G$) and $\mu_G(G) < \infty$ if and only if G is compact.
On the other hand, if ν is another left Haar measure, then there exists $c > 0$ such that

$$\mu(E) = c\nu(E), \quad \forall E \in \mathcal{B}(G).$$

Proof. See for instance Halmos [Hal50, §58] □

Exercise 4.5. If G is a Lie group, then show that any left Haar measure is a smooth measures (as defined in §2.5).

Example 4.1. *The space $\mathbb{R}^d$ is an abelian Lie group and $\mathbb{Z}^d < \mathbb{R}^d$ is a (normal) subgroup. Hence, $\mathbb{T}^d := \mathbb{R}^d/\mathbb{Z}^d$ is a compact abelian Lie group, and there exists a unique left Haar measure λ^d which is a probability measure. The measure λ^d is left and right invariant is usually called the Haar or the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{T}^d$.*

Given a topological group G, we say that a map $f \colon G \circlearrowleft$ is a **topological group endomorphism** (or just an **endomorphism** for short) when f is continuous and $f(xy) = f(x)f(y)$, for every $x, y \in G$. An endomorphism $f \colon G \circlearrowleft$ is said to be a **topological group automorphism** (or just an **automorphism**) when f is bijective and the map f^{-1} is an endomorphism as well.

Exercise 4.6. Let G be a compact topological group, μ be the left Haar probability measure and $f\colon G \circlearrowleft$ be an automorphism.

(a) Show that μ is a right Haar measure too, i.e. it is invariant by every right translation.

(b) Show that μ is an f-invariant measure.

(c) What happens when f is just an endomorphism?

(d) And what happens when G is non-compact and just locally compact?

4.5.1 Compact abelian groups

Let $(G, +)$ be a compact abelian topological group. By Theorem 4.2, we know that every Haar measure on G is finite, by Exercise 4.6, every left Haar measure is a right one. So, there exists a unique Haar probability measure μ on G.

One can show that G is metrizable. So, let $d'\colon G \times G \to \mathbb{R}_0^+$ be a distance function on G which is compatible with the topology of G. Then, we have

Exercise 4.7 (Existence of invariant distance)**.** Show that the function $d\colon G\times G \to \mathbb{R}_0^+$ given by

$$d(g_1, g_2) := \int_G d'(g_1 + h, g_2 + h)\, \mathrm{d}\mu(h), \quad \forall g_1, g_2 \in G,$$

is a distance function which is compatible with the topology of G and L_h is an isometry for d for every $h \in G$, i.e. it holds

$$d(g_1 + h, g_2 + h) = d(g_1, g_2), \quad \forall g_1, g_2, h \in G.$$

Exercise 4.8 (Dynamics of translations)**.** For every $h \in G$, the following statements are equivalent:

(i) L_h is **topologically transitive,** i.e. there is $g \in G$ such that its orbit $\mathcal{O}_{L_h}(g) := \{L_h^n(g) : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is dense in G;

(ii) L_h is **minimal,** i.e. for every $g \in G$, the positive semi-orbit $\mathcal{O}^+_{L_h}(g) := \{L_h^n(g) : n \in \mathbb{N}_0\}$ is dense in G.

4.5.2 Adding machines

There is a particularly interesting family of compact abelian groups with minimal translations, which are usually called *adding machines.* To construct some of these spaces, let us start considering a number $p \in \mathbb{N}$, with $p \geqslant 2$, and the set

$$\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p := \{0, 1, \ldots, p-1\}^{\mathbb{N}_0},$$

endowed with the product topology given by the discrete topology on each factor. By Exercise 4.3, we know that $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$ is a Cantor space. Then, consider the function $\phi\colon \mathbb{N}_0 \to \hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$ given by $\phi(n) = (a_0, a_1, a_2 \ldots) \in \hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$ if and only if there is $m \in \mathbb{N}_0$ such that $a_n = 0$, for every $n \geqslant m$ and $n = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i p^i$. Writing n in base p, one can easily check that function ϕ is indeed well defined, injective and its image is dense in $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$. We can use this function ϕ to endow $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$ with an abelian group structure, turning $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$ into a compact abelian topological group:

Exercise 4.9. Show that there is a unique continuous function $+\colon \hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p \times \hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p \to \hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$ such that

$$\phi(m) + \phi(n) = \phi(m+n), \quad \forall m, n \in \mathbb{N}_0.$$

Then, show that $(\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p, +)$ is indeed an abelian compact topological group, where $+$ is the function we defined above.

As a straight forward consequence of the denseness of the image of ϕ and Exercise 4.9, we get that the translation $L_{\phi(1)}\colon \hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p \circlearrowleft$ is transitive (because the semi-orbit $\mathcal{O}^+_{L_{\phi(1)}}\big(\phi(0)\big) = \phi(\mathbb{N}_0)$ is dense in $\hat{\mathbb{Z}}_p$), and hence, by Exercise 4.8, we conclude that the translation $L_{\phi(1)}$ is minimal.

4.6 The Gauss map

Let us consider the map $G\colon (0,1) \to [0,1)$ given by

$$G(x) := \frac{1}{x} - \left\lfloor \frac{1}{x} \right\rfloor, \quad \forall x \in (0,1).$$

Exercise 4.10. Show that given $x \in (0,1)$ there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $G^n(x) = 0$, if and only if $x \in \mathbb{Q}$.

So, if we define $X = (0,1)\backslash\mathbb{Q}$, then the map $G\big|_X\colon X \circlearrowleft$ is surjective.

A remarkable fact is that there exists a smooth probability measure μ on $(0,1)$ (or on X) which is G-invariant. In fact we have

Theorem 4.3. The measure μ given by

$$\mu(E) := \frac{1}{\log 2} \int_E \frac{\mathrm{d}x}{1+x}, \quad \forall E \in \mathcal{B}(0,1),$$

is a G-invariant Borel probability measure.

Proof. It clearly holds $\mu(0,1) = 1$. Let us prove that μ is G-invariant. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, consider the interval

$$I_n := \left(\frac{1}{n+1}, \frac{1}{n}\right), \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}.$$

Observe that $G_n := G\big|_{I_n}\colon I_n \to (0,1)$ is a C^∞ diffeomorphism, for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, and $m\Big(\bigsqcup_n I_n\Big) = m(0,1) = 1$, where m denotes the Lebesgue measure on $(0,1)$. Given any

$\rho \in L^1((0,1),m)$, with $\rho \geqslant 0$ m-almost everywhere, let us consider the measure μ_ρ given by

$$\mu_\rho(E) := \int_E \rho \, \mathrm{d}m, \quad \forall E \in \mathscr{B}(0,1).$$

If we define the so called *Perron-Frobenious operator* $\mathcal{L}$ by

$$\mathcal{L}\rho(y) := \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \frac{\rho(G_k^{-1}(y))}{G_k'\big(G_k^{-1}(y)\big)}, \quad \forall y \in \bigsqcup_{k\geqslant 1} I_k,$$

we claim that

$$G_\star\mu_\rho(E) = \mu_{\mathcal{L}\rho}(E) = \int_E \mathcal{L}\rho \, \mathrm{d}m, \quad \forall E \in \mathscr{B}(0,1).$$

In order to prove this, let E be an arbitrary Borel subset of $(0,1)$ and let us write $\mathbb{1}_E$ to denote its indicator function. By the classical change of variable formula we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\mu_\rho\big(G^{-1}(E)\big) &= \int_0^1 \mathbb{1}_{G^{-1}(E)}(x)\rho(x)\,\mathrm{d}m(x) = \int_0^1 \mathbb{1}_E\big(G(x)\big)\rho(x)\,\mathrm{d}m(x) \\
&= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \int_{I_n} \mathbb{1}_E\big(G(x)\big)\rho(x)\,\mathrm{d}m(x) \\
&= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \int_0^1 \mathbb{1}_E(y)\rho\big(G_k^{-1}(y)\big)\big(G_k^{-1}\big)'(y)\,\mathrm{d}m(y) \\
&= \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \int_0^1 \mathbb{1}_E(y)\frac{\rho\big(G_k^{-1}(y)\big)}{G_k'\big(G_k^{-1}(y)\big)}\,\mathrm{d}m(y) \\
&= \int_0^1 \mathbb{1}_E(y)\mathcal{L}(\rho)(y)\,\mathrm{d}m(y) = \mu_{\mathcal{L}\rho}(E),
\end{aligned}$$

where the last line of the chain of equalities follows by classical Levi's monotone convergence theorem.

So, if we consider $\rho(x) := \frac{1}{1+x}$, the fact that μ_ρ is a G-invariant (finite) Borel measure follows from the fact that $\mathcal{L}\rho = \rho$ and this easily follows from a straightforward computation. □

4.7 Some important exercises from [VO16, §1.3.7]

1.3.2, 1.3.4, 1.3.5, 1.3.6, 1.3.7, 1.3.9, 1.3.10, 1.3.11, 1.3.12.

5 Constructing new measure preserving systems from old ones

5.1 Product maps

Let $(X_1, \mathscr{B}_1, \mu_1)$ and $(X_2, \mathscr{B}_2, \mu_2)$ be two σ-finite measure spaces. The **product σ-algebra** $\mathscr{B}_1 \otimes \mathscr{B}_2$ on $X_1 \times X_2$ is defined as the σ-algebra generated by the family of *rectangles* $\{E_1 \times E_2 : E_i \in \mathscr{B}_i,\ i \in \{1,2\}\}$. Then, one shows that there exists a unique measure $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ on the measurable space $(X_1 \times X_2, \mathscr{B}_1 \otimes \mathscr{B}_2)$, called the *product measure*, such that

$$\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2(E_1 \times E_2) = \mu_1(E_1)\mu_2(E_2), \quad \forall E_1 \in \mathscr{B}_1,\ \forall E_2 \in \mathscr{B}_2.$$

When $f_i \colon (X_1, \mathscr{B}_i, \mu_i) \circlearrowleft$, for $i \in \{1,2\}$, are measure preserving maps, then invoking Theorem 4.1 one can easily show that the measure $\mu_1 \otimes \mu_2$ is $f_1 \times f_2$-invariant, where $f_1 \times f_2 \colon X_1 \times X_2 \ni (x_1, x_2) \mapsto \big(f_1(x_1), f_2(x_2)\big) \in X_1 \times X_2$.

By induction, this construction can be easily extended from two to any (finite) number of factor maps. Moreover, this construction can be extended to countably many factors, assuming that each factor is a probability space (see [VO16, Appendix A.2] for details).

5.2 Induction or renormalization

Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space, $f \colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map and $A \in \mathscr{B}$ a measurable set with $\mu(A) > 0$. By Poincaré recurrence theorem (Corollary 3.4) we know that μ-almost every point $x \in A$ returns to A infinitely many times. So we can define the function $\rho_A \colon A \to \mathbb{N}$ by

$$\rho_A(x) := \min\{n \in \mathbb{N} : f^n(x) \in A\},$$

and this function is well-defined μ-a.e. on A. Then we define the **first return map to** A by

$$f_A(x) := f^{\rho_A(x)}(x),$$

which is well define μ-a.e. on A. In order to see that f_A is a well defined dynamical system, is enough to observe that if we define

$$A_f := A \cap \left(\bigcap_{m \geqslant 0} \bigcup_{n \geqslant m} f^{-n}(A) \right),$$

then by Corollary 3.4 one have that $\mu(A_f) = \mu(A) > 0$, with $A_f \subset A$, and one can easily check that $\rho_A(x) < \infty$ and $f_A(x) \in A_f$, for every $x \in A_f$. So, this means that $f_A \colon A_f \circlearrowleft$ is a well defined dynamical system. Moreover, if define the probability measure μ_A on the measure space $(A, \mathcal{B}_A)$ by

$$\mu_A(E) := \frac{\mu(E)}{\mu(A)}, \quad \forall E \in \mathscr{B}_A,$$

and where $\mathscr{B}_A := \{B \in \mathscr{B} : B \subset A_f\}$, we have the following

Theorem 5.1. The map $f_A \colon A_f \circlearrowleft$ is a $\mathscr{B}_A$-measurable and the measure μ_A is f_A-invariant.

Proof. For the sake of simplicity of the notation, from now on we shall assume that $A = A_f$,

and for each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let us consider the set $A_n := \rho^{-1}(n) \subset A$. Observe that

$$A = \bigsqcup_{n\in\mathbb{N}} A_n,$$

and for each $E \subset A$, it holds

$$f_A^{-1}(E) = \bigsqcup_{n\in\mathbb{N}} f_A^{-1}(E) \cap A_n = \bigsqcup_{n\in\mathbb{N}} f^{-n}(E) \cap A_n. \tag{8}$$

On the other hand, one can easily check that

$$A_n = \rho^{-1}(n) = A \cap \left(\bigcap_{i=1}^{n-1} f^{-i}(X\backslash A) \right) \cap f^{-n}(A), \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}. \tag{9}$$

From (9) we conclude ρ is a measurable function and then, by (8) we get that f_A is a $\mathscr{B}_A$-measurable map.

Finally, in order to show that μ_A is f_A-invariant, it is enough to show that $\mu(E) = \mu(f_A^{-1}(E))$, for any $E \in \mathscr{B}_A$. In order to prove that, let us fix a measurable set $E \in \mathscr{B}_A$ and observe that, by (8) we get

$$\mu\big(f_A^{-1}(E)\big) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu\big(f^{-n}(E) \cap A_n\big).$$

Let us prove that the right hand side of this equality is equal to $\mu(E)$. To do that, let us start noticing that

$$\begin{aligned} \mu(E) = \mu\big(f^{-1}(E)\big) &= \mu\big(f^{-1}(E) \cap A\big) + \mu\big(f^{-1}(E)\backslash A\big) \\ &= \mu\big(f^{-1}(E) \cap A_1\big) + \mu\big(f^{-1}(E)\backslash A\big), \end{aligned} \tag{10}$$

where the first equality follows from the fact $f^{-1}(E) = \big(f^{-1}(E) \cap A\big) \sqcup \big(f^{-1}(E)\backslash A\big)$, and the second one from $f^{-1}(E) \cap A = f^{-1}(E) \cap A_1$.

Then, focusing on the last term of (10) we get

$$\begin{aligned} \mu\big(f^{-1}(E)\backslash A\big) &= \mu\big(f^{-2}(E)\backslash f^{-1}(A)\big) \\ &= \mu\Big(\big(f^{-2}(E)\backslash f^{-1}(A)\big) \cap A\Big) + \mu\Big(\big(f^{-2}(E)\backslash f^{-1}(A)\big)\backslash A\Big) \\ &= \mu\big(f^{-2}(E) \cap A_2\big) + \mu\Big(f^{-2}(E)\backslash\big(A \cup f^{-1}(A)\big)\Big), \end{aligned} \tag{11}$$

where the first equality follows from the invariance of μ by f, the second one by the partition argument we used above to prove (10), and the last equality follows from the fact that $\big(f^{-2}(E)\backslash f^{-1}(A)\big) \cap A = f^{-1}(E) \cap A_2$.

Combining equations (10) and (11) and repeating inductively the last argument, one can show that

$$\mu(E) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \mu\big(f^{-i}(E) \cap A_i\big) + \mu\Big(f^{-n}(E)\backslash\big(A \cup f^{-1}(A) \cup \cdots \cup f^{-(n-1)}(A)\big)\Big),$$

for every $n \geqslant 1$.

So, in order to prove that $\mu(E) = \mu\big(f^{-1}(E)\big)$ it is enough to show that

$$\mu\Big(f^{-n}(E)\backslash\Big(\bigcup_{i=1}^{n-1} f^{-i}(A)\Big)\Big) \leqslant \mu\Big(f^{-n}(A)\backslash\Big(\bigcup_{i=1}^{n-1} f^{-i}(A)\Big)\Big) \to 0$$

as $n \to +\infty$. But this easily follows from the fact that $f^{-1}(A)\backslash A, f^{-2}(A)\backslash(A \cup f^{-1}(A))\ldots$ are pairwise disjoint and hence,

$$1 = \mu(X) \geqslant \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \mu\Big(f^{-n}(A)\backslash\Big(\bigcup_{i=1}^{n-1} f^{-i}(A)\Big)\Big).$$

□

5.3 Kakutani-Rokhlin towers

In this section we shall try to revert the previous construction we performed in §5.2. To do that, for the time being let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be an arbitrary measure space, $\rho\colon X \to \mathbb{N}_0$ be an integrable function and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map.

We first onsider the new measure space $(X_\rho, \mathscr{B}_\rho, \mu_\rho)$ where each object is defined as follows: we first define the space X_ρ by

$$X_\rho := \bigsqcup_{n\in\mathbb{N}_0} \bigsqcup_{0\leqslant i\leqslant n} \rho^{-1}(n) \times \{i\} \subset X \times \mathbb{N}_0;$$

the σ-algebra $\mathscr{B}_\rho$ is defined as the one generated by the family

$$\mathscr{B}_\rho := \sigma\left\{A \times \{i\} \subset X \times \mathbb{N}_0 : A \in \mathscr{B},\ \exists n \in \mathbb{N}_0,\ 0 \leqslant i \leqslant n,\ A \subset \rho^{-1}(n)\right\};$$

and the measure μ_ρ is characterized as the only measure on the measurable space $(X_\rho, \mathscr{B}_\rho)$ such that

$$\mu_\rho(A \times \{i\}) := \left(\int_X \rho + 1 \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right)^{-1} \mu(A),$$

for every generating set $A \times \{i\}$ of $\mathscr{B}_\rho$.

Exercise 5.1. Show that $(X_\rho, \mathscr{B}_\rho, \mu_\rho)$ is a well-defined probability space.

Then we define the measure preserving map $f_\rho\colon X_\rho \circlearrowleft$ by

$$f_\rho(x, i) := \begin{cases} (x, i+1), & \text{for } x \in X,\ 0 \leqslant i < \rho(x); \\ \big(f(x), 0\big), & \text{for } x \in X,\ i = \rho(x). \end{cases}$$

Exercise 5.2. Show that the map $f_\rho\colon (X_\rho, \mathscr{B}_\rho, \mu_\rho) \circlearrowleft$ is indeed a measure preserving map. Now consider the first return map (also called induction as in §5.2) of the map f_ρ to the set $A := X \times \{0\}$. Show that $\mu_\rho(A) > 0$ and the first return map is "isomorphic" to the original $f\colon (X, \mathscr{B}, \mu) \circlearrowleft$. Can you give a definition of *isomorphism* between measure preserving maps?

5.4 Some important exercises from [VO16, §1.4.4]

1.4.3, 1.4.4.

6 Existence of invariant measures for continuous maps

The main purpose of this section consists in proving the following

Theorem 6.1. Let X be compact metric space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a continuous map. Then, there exists an f-invariant Borel probability measure.

In order to prove Theorem 6.1 we first need to introduce some concepts in Functional Analysis.

6.1 Linear operators and dual spaces

Let $(E, \|\cdot\|_E)$ and $(F, \|\cdot\|_F)$ be two Banach spaces over the field $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$. A linear map $A\colon E \to F$ is continuous if and only its **norm**

$$\|A\| := \sup_{x \in X \setminus \{0\}} \frac{\|Ax\|_F}{\|x\|_E} < \infty. \tag{12}$$

The space of linear continuous maps from E to F is a denoted by $\mathcal{L}(E, F)$ and it turns to be a Banach space when its endowed with the norm given by (12).

When F is the field itself $\mathbb{K}$, a continuous linear operator $\eta\colon E \to \mathbb{K}$ is called a continuous linear functional. The **dual space** $E^\star$ is defined as the linear space $\mathcal{L}(E, \mathbb{K})$. Then we can define the norm $\|\cdot\|_{E^\star}$ on $E^\star$ by

$$\|\eta\|_{E^\star} := \sup\{|\eta(x)| : x \in E,\ \|x\|_E = 1\}, \quad \forall \eta \in E^\star.$$

The linear space $E^\star$ turns into a Banach space when it is endowed with the norm $\|\cdot\|_{E^\star}$. The topology on $E^\star$ induced by the norm $\|\cdot\|_{E^\star}$ is usually called the **strong topology**.

On the other hand, any continuous linear operator $A\colon E \to F$ naturally induces the so callled **adjoint operator** $A\colon F^\star \to E^\star$ given by

$$A^\star \eta(x) := \eta\big(A(x)\big), \quad \forall x \in E,\ \forall \eta \in F^\star.$$

Exercise 6.1. Show that the adjoint operator is indeed a linear continuous operator and $\|A\| \geqslant \|A^\star\|$.

6.2 Weak topologies

Given a topological space (Y, τ_Y), a non-empty set X and an arbitrary family of maps $\mathscr{F} = \{f_i\colon X \to Y\}_{i \in I}$, we define the **weak topology** on X induced by τ_Y and $\mathscr{F}$ as the weakest (i.e. the coarsest) topology τ on X such that $f_i\colon (X, \tau) \to (Y, \tau_Y)$ is continuous, for every $i \in I$.

Now, if $(E, \|\cdot\|_E)$ denotes a Banach space over $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$, and $E^\star$ is its dual space, we can define the so called **weak topology** on E as the weak topology induced by the family $E^\star$, i.e. it is the weakest topology on E such that every $\eta \in E^\star$ is continuous on E. In general, the weak topology is weaker than the Banach topology induced by the norm $\|\cdot\|_E$.

Exercise 6.2. Show that if E is a Banach space, then norm and the weak topologies coincide if and only if E has finite dimension.

Now, we can consider the space $E^{\star\star} := (E^\star)^\star$ which is the dual space of the Banach space $(E^\star, \|\cdot\|_{E^\star})$. Analogously, we can endow the space $E^\star$ with the **weak topology** which is the weakest topology such that every element of $E^{\star\star}$ is continuous.

However, there shall need to endow the space $E^\star$ with a weaker topology which is defined as follows. One can show that there is a natural injection of E into $E^{\star\star}$, i.e. a linear continuous injective map $j\colon E \to E^{\star\star}$ which is given by

$$j(x)(\eta) := \eta(x), \quad \forall x \in E,\ \forall \eta \in E^\star.$$

Then, the so called **weak-$\star$ topology** is the weakest topology on $E^\star$ such that every linear functional in $j(E)$ is continuous. Given a sequence $(\phi_n)_{n\geqslant 1} \subset E^\star$, we shall write

$$\eta_n \rightharpoonup \eta \in E^\star, \quad \text{as } n \to \infty,$$

when the sequence $(\eta_n)_{n\geqslant 1}$ converges to η in the weak-$\star$ topology.

Exercise 6.3. Show that the weak and weak-$\star$ topologies coincide on $E^\star$ if and only if E is reflexive space, i.e. $j(E) = E^{\star\star}$. On the other hand, show that that the *closed unit ball* on a Banach space E, which is given by $\{x \in E : \|x\|_E \leqslant 1\}$ is compact if and only if E has finite dimension.

We shall need the following

Theorem 6.2 (Banach-Alaoglu theorem)**.** The closed unit ball $\{\eta \in E^\star : \|\eta\|_{E^\star} \leqslant 1\}$ is a compact set when $E^\star$ is with its weak-$\star$ topology.

Proof. See for instance [EW17, Theorem 8.10]. □

6.3 The space of continuous functions

Let (X, d) be a compact metric space and write $C^0(X)$ to denote the space of continuous real functions on X. Since X is compact, any continuous function is bounded and hence, we can define the norm

$$\|\phi\|_0 := \sup_{x\in X} |\phi(x)|, \quad \forall \phi \in C^0(X).$$

Exercise 6.4. Show that $C^0(X)$ is a Banach space when it is endowed with the norm $\|\cdot\|$.

Given an arbitrary continuous map $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$, we can consider the **induced pull-back linear map,** also called the **Koopman operator** $U_f\colon C^0(X) \circlearrowleft$ given by

$$U_f(\phi) := \phi \circ f, \quad \forall \phi \in C^0(X).$$

Exercise 6.5. Show that U_f is a continuous linear operator and its norm

$$\|U_f\| := \sup\left\{\|U_f(\phi)\|_0 : \phi \in C^0(X), \|\phi\|_0 = 1\right\} = 1.$$

Moreover, $\|U_f\phi\| = \|\phi\|$, for every $\phi \in C^0(X)$ if and only if f is surjective.

On the other hand, we have the following

Theorem 6.3 (Riesz representation theorem)**.** If $\eta\colon C^0(X) \to \mathbb{R}$ is a continuous linear functional on the Banach space $(C^0(X), \|\cdot\|)$, then there exist two finite Borel measures μ^- and μ^+ on X such that

$$\eta(\phi) = \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu^+ - \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu^-, \quad \forall \phi \in C^0(X).$$

Proof. See for instance Einsiedler and Ward [EW17, Theorem 7.44]. □

Then, let us write $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ for the space of Borel probability measures on X. By Theorem 6.3 we can consider $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ as a subset of unit ball of the dual space $C^0(X)^\star$. On the other hand, by Exercise 2.2 we know that the restriction of the adjoint operator of U_f to the space $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ coincide with the push-forward operator $f_{star}\colon \mathfrak{M}(X) \circlearrowleft$. In particular, we conclude $f_\star\colon \mathfrak{M}(X) \circlearrowleft$ is continuous when $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ is endowed with the weak-$\star$ topology that inherits from the inclusion $\mathfrak{M}(X) \subset C^0(X)^\star$.

Exercise 6.6. Show that the space of Borel probability measures $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ is a closed subset of the closed unit ball $\bar{B} := \left\{\xi \in C^0(X)^\star : \|\xi\| \leqslant 1\right\}$ when it is endowed with the weak-$\star$ topology. Then, invoking Theorem 6.2, conclude that $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ is compact with the weak-$\star$ topology.

Now we can complete the

Proof of Theorem 6.1. Let ν be any Borel probability measure on X. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let us consider the measure $\mu_n \in \mathfrak{M}(X)$ given by

$$\mu_n := \frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} f_\star^j \nu.$$

By Exercise 6.6 we know that $\mathfrak{M}(X)$ is compact for the weak-$\star$ topology. So, there exists a subsequent $(\mu_{n_j})_{j\geqslant 1}$ and $\mu \in \mathfrak{M}(X)$ such that $\mu_{n_j} \rightharpoonup \mu$, as $n_j \to \infty$. The, since $f_\star\colon \mathfrak{M}(X) \circlearrowleft$ is continuous, we get $f_\star\mu_{n_j} \rightharpoonup f_\star\mu$, as $n_j \to \infty$. So, in order to show that μ is f-invariant, it is enough to show that $f_\star\mu_n - \mu_n \rightharpoonup 0$, as $n \to \infty$. In order to do that, let $\phi \in C^0(X)$ be arbitrary and notice that

$$\int_x \phi \, \mathrm{d}(f_\star\mu_n - \mu_n) = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1}\left(\int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}f_\star^{j+1}\nu - \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}f_\star^j\nu\right) = \frac{1}{n}\int_X \phi\circ f^n - \phi \, \mathrm{d}\nu \to 0,$$

as $n \to +\infty$. □

Exercise 6.7. Let X and Y be two compact metric spaces, and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ and $g\colon X \times Y \to Y$ two continuous functions. Let us consider the so called *skew-product map* $H\colon X \times Y \circlearrowleft$ given by

$$H(x,y) := \big(f(x), g(x,y)\big), \quad \forall (x,y) \in X \times Y.$$

Given any invariant measure $\mu \in \mathfrak{M}(f)$, let us show that there exists an invariant measure $\hat{\mu} \in \mathfrak{M}(H)$ such that $\pi_\star \hat{\mu} = \mu$, where $\pi\colon X \times Y \to X$ denotes the projection on the first coordinate.

6.4 Some important exercises from [VO16, §2.1.6]

2.1.2, 2.1.3, 2.1.4, 2.1.6.

6.5 Some important exercises from [VO16, §2.2.1]

2.2.1, 2.2.2, 2.2.3, 2.2.4, 2.2.5.

7 Ergodic theorems

Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ a measure preserving endomorphism. Let $E \in \mathscr{B}$ be a subset such that $\mu(E) > 0$. Then by Poincare's recurrence theorem (Corollary 3.4) we know that the set $\{i \in \mathbb{N}_0 : f^i(x) \in E\}$ is infinite for μ-almost every point $x \in E$. This can be considered as a qualitative information. In this section we shall focus on the problem of finding quantitative estimates for the frequency of sojourn

$$\frac{1}{n}\sharp\{i \in \mathbb{N}_0 : i < n,\ f^i(x) \in E\} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \mathbb{1}_E \circ f^i(x),$$

as $n \to \infty$, and where $\mathbb{1}_E\colon X \to \{0,1\}$ denotes the indicator function of the set E. To do that, we shall analyze the asymptotic behavior of so called **Birkhoff averages** as the following one:

$$\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi := \frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi \circ f^j,$$

for an arbitrary integrable function $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$.

The first result concerning the asymptotic behavior of Birkhoff averages is the celebrated

Theorem 7.1 (von Neumann Ergodic Theorem)**.** Let $(x, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving endomorphism. Then, for every $\phi \in L^2(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, there is a $\tilde{\phi} \in L^2(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ such that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi \circ f^j \to \tilde{\phi}, \quad \text{in } L^2(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu),$$

as $n \to +\infty$. Moreover, it holds

$$\tilde{\phi}(x) = \tilde{\phi}\big(f(x)\big), \quad \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x \in X.$$

In order to prove Theorem 7.1, we first need to revise some concepts on Lebesgue and Hilbert spaces.

7.1 Revision on Lebesgue spaces

Let $(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ be an arbitrary measure space. For each real number p with $1 \leqslant p < \infty$, let us consider the space $L^p(X, \mathcal{B}, \mu)$ of (equivalence classes of) measurable functions $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{C}$ such that $|\phi|^p$ is integrable, and where two functions are equivalent if and only if they coincide μ-almost everywhere on X. Then one can show that the $L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is a Banach space when it is endowed with the norm

$$\|\phi\|_p := \left(\int_X |\phi|^p \, \mathrm{d}\mu\right)^{1/p}, \quad \forall \phi \in L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu).$$

On the other hand, we define the space $L^\infty(X, B, \mu)$ as the space of (equivalence classes of) measurable functions $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{C}$ such that there exists $C > 0$ satisfying $|\phi(x)| \leqslant C$, for μ-almost every $x \in X$, and where two functions are equivalent when they coincide μ-almost

everywhere. The space $L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ is a Banach space when it is endowed with the norm

$$\|\phi\|_\infty := \inf\{C>0 : |\phi(x)|\leqslant C,\ \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x\in X\},\quad \forall \phi\in L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu).$$

Exercise 7.1. If $(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ is a probability space, $1\leqslant p<q\leqslant\infty$ and $\phi\in L^q(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, then show that $\phi\in L^p(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ and $\|\phi\|_p\leqslant\|\phi\|_q$. On the other hand, show that

$$\|\psi\|_\infty = \lim_{p\to\infty}\|\psi\|_p,\quad \forall\psi\in L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu).$$

Exercise 7.2. Consider the map $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle\colon L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\times L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\to\mathbb{C}$ given by

$$\langle\phi,\psi\rangle := \int_X \phi\overline{\psi}\,\mathrm{d}\mu,\quad \forall\phi,\psi\in L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu).$$

Show that $\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle$ is well defined, is a scalar product and it turns $L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ into a Hilbert space.
A Banach space is said to be *Hibertlizable* when one can define a scalar product on it that turns it into a Hilbert space and whose topology coincides with the original one given by the Banach structure.
Show that the Lebesgue space $L^p(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ is Hilbertlizable if and only if $p=2$.

Given a probability space $(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, a measure preserving map $f\colon X\circlearrowleft$, and a measurable function $\phi\colon X\to\mathbb{C}$, consider the new measurable function $U_f\phi := \phi\circ f$. The map U_f is called the **Koopman operator**.

Exercise 7.3. For every $p\in[1,\infty]$, show that $U_f\phi\in L^p(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, whenever $\phi\in L^p(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$. Moreover, show that $U_f\colon L^p(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\circlearrowleft$ is a linear isometry, i.e. $\|U_f\phi\|_p=\|\phi\|_p$, for every $\phi\in L^p(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ and every $p\in[1,\infty]$.

7.2 Revision of Hilbert space theory

Let $(\mathscr{H},\langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle)$ be a Hilbert over the field $\mathbb{K}=\mathbb{R},\mathbb{C}$. We will write $E<\mathscr{H}$ when E is a closed linear subspace. Given any non-empty subset $F\subset\mathscr{H}$, we define its **orthogonal complement** $F^\perp$ by

$$F^\perp := \{x\in\mathscr{H} : \langle x,y\rangle = 0,\ \forall y\in F\}.$$

Observe that $F^\perp<\mathscr{H}$ and $F\cap F^\perp$ is either empty or the singleton $\{0\}$.

We will need the following

Theorem 7.2 (Projection on convex subsets)**.** Let $K \subset \mathscr{H}$ be a non-empty convex closed set. Then there is a continuous map $P_K \colon \mathscr{H} \to K$ such that for every $x \in \mathscr{H}$ the vector $P_K(x)$ is the only one in K such that

$$\|x - P_k(x)\| = \inf\{\|x - y\| : y \in K\}.$$

Moreover, if K is closed linear subspace, then P_K is a linear continuous map such that

$$\langle x - P_K(x), y\rangle = 0, \quad \forall x \in \mathscr{H},\ \forall y \in K.$$

In particular, it holds $\ker P_K = K^\perp$ and $K \oplus K^\perp = \mathscr{H}$.

Proof. See for instance [EW17, Theorem 3.13 and Corollary 3.17]. □

Let $\mathscr{H}^\star$ denote its dual space, i.e. the space of continuous linear functionals on $\mathscr{H}$. We have the following

Theorem 7.3 (Riesz representation theorem for Hilbert spaces)**.** For every $\eta \in \mathscr{H}^\star$, there exists a unique $v_\eta \in \mathscr{H}$ such that

$$\eta(x) = \langle x, v_\eta\rangle, \quad \forall x \in \mathscr{H}.$$

Proof. See for instance [EW17, Corollary 3.19]. □

Theorem 7.3 lets us redefine the concept of adjoint operator on Hilbert spaces. Given two Hilbert spaces $(\mathscr{H}, \langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle_{\mathscr{H}})$ and $(\mathscr{J}, \langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle_{\mathscr{J}})$ over $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$, and a continuous linear operator $A \in \mathcal{L}(\mathscr{H}, \mathscr{J})$, we define its **adjoint operator** $A^\star \colon \mathscr{J} \to \mathscr{H}$ by the following property:

$$\langle Ax, y\rangle = \langle x, A^\star y\rangle, \quad \forall x \in \mathscr{H},\ \forall y \in \mathscr{J}.$$

Exercise 7.4. Show that $A^\star \in \mathcal{L}(\mathscr{J}, \mathscr{H})$, for every $A \in \mathcal{L}(\mathscr{H}, \mathscr{J})$.

A linear operator $U \in \mathcal{L}(\mathscr{H}, \mathscr{J})$ is said to be an **isometry** when

$$\|Ux\|_{\mathscr{J}} = \|x\|_{\mathscr{H}}, \quad \forall x \in \mathscr{H}.$$

Exercise 7.5. Let $U \colon \mathscr{H} \to \mathscr{J}$ be a continuous linear operator. Show that the following statements are equivalent:

1. U is an isometry;
2. $\langle Ux, Uy\rangle_{\mathscr{J}} = \langle x, y\rangle_{\mathscr{H}}$, for every $x, y \in \mathscr{H}$;
3. $U^\star U = I$, where $I \in \mathcal{L}(\mathscr{H})$ denotes the identity map.

A surjective isometry $U \in \mathcal{L}(\mathscr{H})$ is called a **unitary operator**. One can easily check that U is a unitary operator if and only if $U^\star U = UU^\star = I$.

7.3 von Neumann's ergodic theorem on Hilbert spaces

Now we can prove the so called von Neumann's ergodic theorem for isometries on Hilbert spaces:

Theorem 7.4. Let $\mathscr{H}$ be a Hilbert space over $\mathbb{K} = \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$ and $U \colon \mathscr{H} \to \mathscr{H}$ be a linear isometry. Let $\mathscr{I} := \ker(U - I) < \mathscr{H}$ and $P_{\mathscr{I}} \colon \mathscr{H} \to \mathscr{I}$ the projection map given by Theorem 7.2. Then, it holds

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} U^i x \to P_{\mathscr{I}}(x), \quad \forall x \in \mathscr{H},$$

as $n \to +\infty$.

Proof. Let us start considering the closed linear space

$$E = \overline{(U - I)\mathscr{H}}.$$

Let us show that $\mathscr{I} = E^\perp$. In fact, first observe that for every $x \in \mathscr{H}$ and any $y \in \mathscr{I}$ we have

$$\langle Ux - x, y \rangle = \langle Ux, y \rangle - \langle x, y \rangle = \langle Ux, Uy \rangle - \langle x, y \rangle = 0,$$

where the last equality follows from the fact that U is an isometry and Exercise 7.5. So, $\mathscr{I} \subset E^\perp$.

On the other hand, if $y \in E^\perp$, then we have

$$0 = \langle Ux - x, y \rangle = \langle Ux, y \rangle - \langle x, y \rangle = \langle x, U^\star y \rangle - \langle x, y \rangle = \langle x, U^\star y - y \rangle,$$

for every $x \in \mathscr{H}$. So, by Theorem 7.3 we have that $U^\star y - y = 0$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} \|Uy - y\|^2 &= \langle Uy - y, Uy - y \rangle = \|Uy\|^2 - \langle Uy, y \rangle - \langle y, Uy \rangle + \|y\|^2 \\ &= \|y\|^2 - \langle y, U^\star y \rangle - \langle U^\star y, y \rangle - \|y\|^2 \\ &= \|y\|^2 - \|y\|^2 - \|y\|^2 + \|y\|^2 = 0. \end{aligned}$$

So, $y \in \mathscr{I}$ and we have proved that $\mathscr{I} = E^\perp$. Hence, it holds $\mathscr{H} = \mathscr{I} \oplus E$ and in order to conclude the proof it is enough to show that

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} U^i x \to 0, \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty, \tag{13}$$

for every $x \in E$. To do that, let x denote an arbitrary point of E and $\varepsilon > 0$ be any positive real number. So, there exists a $y \in \mathscr{H}$ such that

$$\|x - (Uy - y)\| < \frac{\varepsilon}{2},$$

and we get

$$\begin{aligned}\left\|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}U^i x\right\| &= \frac{1}{n}\left\|\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}U^i\Big(\big(Uy-y\big)+x-\big(Uy-y\big)\Big)\right\| \\ &\leqslant \frac{1}{n}\left\|\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}U^{i+1}y-U^i y\right\| + \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}\left\|U^i\big(x-(Uy-y)\big)\right\| \\ &= \frac{\|U^n y-y\|}{n} + \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}\|x-(Uy-y)\| \leqslant \frac{2}{n}\|y\| + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} \leqslant \varepsilon,\end{aligned}$$

for every $n \geqslant \dfrac{4\|y\|}{\varepsilon}$. Since $\varepsilon > 0$ is arbitrary, we conclude that (13) holds. □

Proof of Theorem 7.1. It is a straightforward consequence of Theorem 7.4 and the fact that the Koopman operator $U_f\colon L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu) \circlearrowleft$ is an isometry (Exercise 7.3). □

Here we review some interesting consequences of von Neumann's ergodic theorem (Theorem 7.1):

Corollary 7.5. Let $(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving automorphism. Then, for every $\phi \in L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, there exists $\tilde{\phi} \in L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ such that

$$\lim_{n\to+\infty}\frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1}\phi\circ f^i = \lim_{n\to-\infty}\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}\phi\circ f^{-i} = \tilde{\phi},$$

where both limits are taken in L^2.

Proof. This is a straightforward consequence of Theorem 7.4 and the simple fact that U_f and $U_{f^{-1}} = {U_f}^{-1}$ are isometries, and $\ker(U_f - I) = \ker(U_{f^{-1}} - I)$ □

Corollary 7.6. Let $(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ be a probability space, $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be measure preserving map and $\phi \in L^1(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$. Then, there is $\tilde{\phi} \in L^1(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ such that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1}\phi\circ f^i \to \tilde{\phi}, \quad \text{in } L^1,$$

as $n \to +\infty$.

Proof. For the sake of simplicity of notation, given any $\psi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$ and any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let us write $\mathcal{S}_f^n\psi$ for the Birkhoff average of order n of ψ over f, i.e. we have

$$\mathcal{S}_f^n\psi = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1}\psi\circ f^j.$$

Let us fix a real number $\varepsilon > 0$. Since $L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ is dense in $L^1(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, there is $\xi \in L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ such that

$$\|\phi-\xi\|_1 < \frac{\varepsilon}{4},$$

and then,

$$\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi - \mathcal{S}_f^n\xi\right\|_1 < \frac{\varepsilon}{4}, \quad \forall n \geqslant 1.$$

On the other hand, by Theorem 7.1 we know that there is $\tilde{\xi} \in L^2(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ such that

$$\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\xi - \tilde{\xi}\right\|_2 \to 0, \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty,$$

and thus, there is $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\xi - \tilde{\xi}\right\|_1 \leqslant \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\xi - \tilde{\xi}\right\|_2 < \varepsilon/4, \quad \forall n \geqslant N.$$

Putting together all these estimates we get

$$\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^m\phi - \mathcal{S}_f^n\phi\right\|_1 \leqslant \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^m\phi - \mathcal{S}_f^m\xi\right\|_1 + \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^m\xi - \tilde{\xi}\right\|_1 + \left\|\tilde{\xi} - \mathcal{S}_f^n\xi\right\|_1 + \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\xi - \mathcal{S}_f^n\phi\right\|_1 < \varepsilon,$$

for every $m, n \geqslant N$. So, $\left(\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi\right)_{n\geqslant 1}$ is a Cauchy sequence in $L^1(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and hence, there exists its limit $\tilde{\phi} \in L^1(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$. □

7.4 Some important exercises from [VO16, §3.1.4]

3.1.1, 3.1.2, 3.1.3.

7.5 Birkhoff ergodic theorem

Now we are going to prove that indeed pointwise convergence holds on Corollary 7.6:

Theorem 7.7 (Birkhoff ergodic theorem)**.** Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space, $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ a measure preserving map and $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$ any integrable function. Then there is $\tilde{\phi} \in L^1(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ such that

$$\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi(x) = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big) \to \tilde{\phi}(x), \quad \text{as } n \to \infty,$$

for μ-almost every $x \in X$.
Moreover, it holds

$$\int_X \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu = \int_X \tilde{\phi} \,\mathrm{d}\mu,$$

and

$$\tilde{\phi}(x) = \tilde{\phi}\big(f(x)\big), \quad \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x \in X.$$

In order to prove Theorem 7.7 we first need some preliminary results:

Lemma 7.8 (Borel-Cantelli)**.** Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $A_1, A_2, \ldots \in \mathscr{B}$ be a sequence of measurable sets. If

$$\sum_{n \geqslant 1} \mu(A_n) < \infty,$$

then it holds

$$\mu\Big(\limsup_n A_n\Big) = 0,$$

where the *limit superior* of the sequence (A_n) is defined by

$$\limsup_n A_n := \bigcap_{m \geqslant 1} \bigcup_{n \geqslant m} A_n.$$

Proof. For each $m \in \mathbb{N}$, let us consider the set

$$B_m := \bigcup_{n \geqslant m} A_n.$$

Observe that $B_1 \supset B_2 \supset \cdots$ and since $\sum_{n \geqslant 1} \mu(A_n) < \infty$, it holds $\mu(B_m) \leqslant \sum_{n \geqslant m} \mu(A_n) \to 0$, as $m \to \infty$. Finally, notice that

$$\mu\Big(\limsup_n A_n\Big) = \mu\Big(\bigcap_{m \geqslant 1} B_m\Big) = \lim_{m \to \infty} \mu(B_m) = 0.$$

□

Lemma 7.9. Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $\phi \in L^1(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$. Then it holds

$$\lim_{n \to +\infty} \frac{\phi\big(f^n(x)\big)}{n} = 0, \quad \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x \in X.$$

Proof. For the sake of simplicity of notation, given any $\psi \colon X \to \mathbb{R}$ and any $A \subset \mathbb{R}$ and any $r \in \mathbb{R}$ let us write

$$[\psi \in A] := \psi^{-1}(A), \quad \text{and} \quad [\psi > r] := [\psi \in (r, \infty)].$$

Then, first observe that given an arbitrary point $x \in X$, the sequence $\phi(f^n(x))/n$ does not converge to 0 if and only if the limit superior of $|\phi(f^n(x))|/n$ is positive. So, we have

$$\left\{ x \in X : \frac{\phi\big(f^n(x)\big)}{n} \nrightarrow 0, \text{ as } n \to +\infty \right\} = \bigcup_{p \geqslant 1} \bigcap_{m \geqslant 1} \bigcup_{n \geqslant m} \left[\frac{|\phi \circ f^n|}{n} > \frac{1}{p} \right].$$

Thus in order to prove this lemma, it is enough to show that given any $\varepsilon > 0$,

$$\mu\left(\limsup_n \left[\frac{|\phi \circ f^n|}{n} > \varepsilon \right] \right) = 0,$$

and by Lemma 7.8, to prove this last equality it is enough to show that

$$\sum_{n\geqslant 1}\mu\left[\frac{|\phi\circ f^n|}{n}>\varepsilon\right]<\infty.$$

Finally, to prove the convergence of this series, observe that

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{n\geqslant 1}\mu\left[\frac{|\phi\circ f^n|}{n}>\varepsilon\right]&=\sum_{n\geqslant 1}\mu\left(f^{-n}\left[\frac{|\phi|}{n}>\varepsilon\right]\right)=\sum_{n\geqslant 1}\mu\left[\frac{|\phi|}{n}>\varepsilon\right]\\ \sum_{n\geqslant 1}\mu\left[\frac{|\phi|}{\varepsilon}>n\right]&=\sum_{n\geqslant 1}\sum_{j\geqslant n}\mu\left[j<\frac{|\phi|}{\varepsilon}\leqslant j+1\right]\\ &=\sum_{j\geqslant 1}j\mu\left[j<\frac{|\phi|}{\varepsilon}\leqslant j+1\right]\leqslant\int_X\frac{|\phi|}{\varepsilon}\,\mathrm{d}\mu<\infty.\end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 7.10 (Maximal ergodic theorem)**.** Let $(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, f and ϕ as in Theorem 7.7. For any $\alpha>0$, let us consider the set

$$E^\alpha(\phi):=\left[\sup_{n\geqslant 1}\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi>\alpha\right]=\left\{x\in X:\sup_{n\geqslant 1}\frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1}\phi\big(f^j(x)\big)>\alpha\right\}.$$

Then it holds

$$\int_{E^\alpha(\phi)}\phi\,\mathrm{d}\mu\geqslant\alpha\mu\big(E^\alpha(\phi)\big).$$

Proof of Theorem 7.10. Let us start noticing that given any $\alpha\in\mathbb{R}$ and any $\phi\in L^1(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$, it holds

$$E^\alpha(\phi)=E^0(\phi-\alpha),$$

and therefore,

$$\int_{E^0(\phi-\alpha)}\phi-\alpha\,\mathrm{d}\mu\geqslant 0\quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad\int_{E^\alpha(\phi)}\phi\,\mathrm{d}\mu\geqslant\alpha\mu(E^\alpha(\phi)).$$

So, it is enough to prove this theorem for $\alpha=0$.

For each $n\geqslant 1$, let us consider the function

$$\phi_n(x):=\sup\left\{\sum_{j=0}^{k-1}\phi\big(f^j(x)\big):1\leqslant k\leqslant n\right\},\quad\forall x\in X.$$

If we write $[\phi_n>0]:=\{x\in X:\phi_n(x)>0\}$, so it holds $[\phi_n>0]\subset[\phi_{n+1}>0]$, for every $n\geqslant 1$ and

$$E^0(\phi):=\bigcup_{n\geqslant 1}[\phi_n>0].$$

Thus, to prove that $\int_{E^0(\phi)}\phi\,\mathrm{d}\mu\geqslant 0$, by the dominated convergence theorem it is enough to show that

$$\int_{[\phi_n>0]}\phi\,\mathrm{d}\mu\geqslant 0,\quad\forall n\geqslant 1.$$

Then, given any $n \geqslant 1$ and any $m \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$, we know that

$$\phi_n(x) \geqslant \sum_{j=0}^{m-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big), \quad \forall x \in X,$$

and hence,

$$\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) + \phi(x) \geqslant \sum_{j=0}^{m} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big), \quad \forall x \in X,\ \forall m \in \{1, \dots, n\}. \tag{14}$$

Fixing a point $x \in X$, let us consider the two possible cases: either $\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) \geqslant 0$ or $\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) < 0$.

In the first case, when $\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) \geqslant 0$, we have $\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) + \phi(x) \geqslant \phi(x)$. Then, by estimate (14) it follows that

$$\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) + \phi(x) \geqslant \phi_n(x), \quad \forall x \in [\phi_n \circ f \geqslant 0].$$

In the second case, when $\phi_n\big(f(x)\big) < 0$, by (14) we get

$$\phi(x) \geqslant \sum_{j=0}^{m} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big) - \phi_n\big(f(x)\big) > \sum_{j=0}^{m} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big), \quad \forall m \in \{1, \dots, n\},$$

and then, $\phi_n(x) = \phi(x)$, whenever $x \in [\phi_n \circ f < 0]$.

Putting together these estimates we get

$$\begin{aligned}
\int_{[\phi_n>0]} \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu &= \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f<0]} \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu + \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f\geqslant 0]} \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu \\
&\geqslant \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f<0]} \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu + \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f\geqslant 0]} \phi_n - \phi_n \circ f \, \mathrm{d}\mu \\
&= \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f<0]} \phi_n \, \mathrm{d}\mu + \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f\geqslant 0]} \phi_n - \phi_n \circ f \, \mathrm{d}\mu \\
&= \int_{[\phi_n>0]} \phi_n \, \mathrm{d}\mu - \int_{[\phi_n>0]\cap[\phi_n\circ f\geqslant 0]} \phi_n \circ f \, \mathrm{d}\mu \\
&\geqslant \int_{[\phi_n>0]} \phi_n \, \mathrm{d}\mu - \int_{[\phi_n\circ f\geqslant 0]} \phi_n \circ f \, \mathrm{d}\mu \\
&= \int_{[\phi_n>0]} \phi_n \, \mathrm{d}\mu - \int_{[\phi_n\geqslant 0]} \phi_n \, \mathrm{d}(f_\star\mu) = 0.
\end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 7.11. If $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, f, α and ϕ are as in Theorem 7.10 and $A \in \mathscr{B}$ satisfies $A \subset E^\alpha(\phi)$ and $f^{-1}(A) = A$, then it holds

$$\int_A \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu \geqslant \alpha\mu(A).$$

Exercise 7.6. Prove Corollary 7.11.

Now we are ready for

Proof of Theorem 7.7. Let us start considering the functions $\overline{\phi}, \underline{\phi}\colon X \to [-\infty, +\infty]$ given by

$$\overline{\phi}(x) := \limsup_{n\to+\infty} \mathcal{S}_f^n \phi(x) \quad \text{and} \quad \underline{\phi}(x) := \liminf_{n\to+\infty} \mathcal{S}_f^n \phi(x),$$

for every $x \in X$.

Exercise 7.7. Using Lemma 7.9, show that the functions $\overline{\phi}$ and $\underline{\phi}$ are (essentially) f-invariant.

Our purpose now consists in showing that the functions $\overline{\phi}$ and $\underline{\phi}$ coincide μ-a.e. In order to prove that, given real numbers $\alpha < \beta$, consider the set

$$E_\alpha^\beta := \left\{x \in X : \underline{\phi}(x) < \alpha < \beta < \overline{\phi}(x)\right\},$$

and observe that

$$[\underline{\phi} \neq \overline{\phi}] = [\underline{\phi} < \overline{\phi}] = \bigcup_{\alpha,\beta\in\mathbb{Q},\ \alpha<\beta} E_\alpha^\beta$$

So, to prove that $\underline{\phi}$ and $\overline{\phi}$ coincide μ-a.e. it is enough to show that $\mu\big(E_\alpha^\beta\big) = 0$, for every pair of real numbers $\alpha < \beta$.

Since $\underline{\phi}$ and $\overline{\phi}$ are f-invariant, it is easy to show that $f^{-1}\Big(E_\alpha^\beta\Big) = E_\alpha^\beta$ up to sets of μ-measure zero. Then, observing that $E_\alpha^\beta \subset E^\beta(\phi)$, where the last set is defined as in Theorem 7.10, applying Corollary 7.11 we can conclude

$$\int_{E_\alpha^\beta} \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu \geqslant \beta\mu\Big(E_\alpha^\beta\Big).$$

On the other hand, notice that $E_\alpha^\beta \subset E^{-\alpha}(-\phi)$. So, we can again apply Corollary 7.11 to the function $-\phi$ to get

$$\int_{E_\alpha^\beta} -\phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu \geqslant -\alpha\mu\Big(E_\alpha^\beta\Big).$$

Putting together these estimates we conclude

$$\beta\mu\Big(E_\alpha^\beta\Big) \leqslant \alpha\mu\Big(E_\alpha^\beta\Big),$$

and since $\alpha < \beta$, this can only happend when $\mu\Big(E_\alpha^\beta\Big) = 0$.

The fact that $\tilde{\phi} := \underline{\phi} = \overline{\phi}$ belongs to $L^1(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and

$$\int_X \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu = \int_X \tilde{\phi} \,\mathrm{d}\mu,$$

will be proved in Corollary 7.13 □

There are some important consequences of Birkhoff ergodic theorem:

Corollary 7.12. If $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and f are as in Theorem 7.7 and $\phi \in L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ with $1 \leqslant p < \infty$, then the limit function $\tilde{\phi}$ given by Theorem 7.7 belongs to $L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and it holds

$$\left\|\tilde{\phi}\right\|_p \leqslant \|\phi\|_p .$$

Proof. Notice that

$$\left|\tilde{\phi}(x)\right| \leqslant \lim_{n\to+\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left|\phi \circ f^j(x)\right|, \quad \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x \in X,$$

and hence,

$$\left|\tilde{\phi}(x)\right|^p \leqslant \lim_{n\to+\infty} \left(\frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left|\phi \circ f^j(x)\right|\right)^p .$$

Then, as a consequence of Fatou lemma and Minkowski inequality we get

$$\begin{aligned}\left\|\tilde{\phi}\right\|_p = \left[\int_X \left|\tilde{\phi}(x)\right|^p \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right]^{\frac{1}{p}} &\leqslant \liminf_n \left[\int_X \left(\frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left|\phi\big(f^j(x)\big)\right|\right)^p \mathrm{d}\mu\right]^{\frac{1}{p}} \\ &\leqslant \liminf_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \left(\int_X \left|\phi\big(f^j(x)\big)\right|^p \mathrm{d}\mu\right)^{\frac{1}{p}} = \|\phi\|_p .\end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 7.13 (L^p-convergence of ergodic averages)**.** If $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, f, ϕ and $\tilde{\phi}$ are as in Corollary 7.12, then

$$\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_p \to 0,$$

as $n \to +\infty$,and where $\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi \circ f^j$. Therefore, it holds

$$\int_X \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu = \int_X \tilde{\phi} \,\mathrm{d}\mu.$$

Proof. By Corollary 7.13 we know that $\tilde{\phi} \in L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$. Then to prove the converges in L^p, let us start assuming $\phi \in L^\infty(x, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$. So, $\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi\right\|_\infty \leqslant \|\phi\|_\infty$, for every $n \geqslant 1$, and hence, $\tilde{\phi} \in L^\infty(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, as well. So,

$$\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_p \leqslant \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_\infty \leqslant \|\phi\|_\infty + \left\|\tilde{\phi}\right\|_\infty ,$$

and $\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi \to \tilde{\phi}$, μ-a.e. as $n \to \infty$. So, by dominated convergence theorem, it holds $\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n \phi - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_p \to 0$, as $n \to \infty$.

Now, to prove the convergence in L^p without the additional assumption that ϕ is bounded, let us consider a sequence of truncations of ϕ, i.e. for each $k \in \mathbb{N}$ let us consider the function $\phi^{(k)}(x) := \phi(x) \mathbb{1}_{\phi^{-1}[-k,k]}(x)$. Observe that $\phi^{(k)} \in L^\infty(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ for every k and $\phi^{(k)} \to \phi$ as $k \to \infty$, μ-almost everywhere and in L^p.

So, given any $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\left\|\phi^{(k)} - \phi\right\|_p < \varepsilon/3$, and hence, $\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n(\phi^{(k)} - \phi)\right\|_p < \varepsilon/3$, for every $n \geqslant 1$, and by Corollary 7.13, it holds

$$\left\|\tilde{\phi}^{(k)} - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_p \leqslant \left\|\phi^{(k)} - \phi\right\|_p < \frac{\varepsilon}{3}.$$

Then, by the previous argument, we have $\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi^{(k)} - \tilde{\phi}^{(k)}\right\|_p < \varepsilon/3$, whenever n is sufficiently large, and so we get

$$\begin{aligned}\left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_p &\leqslant \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi - \mathcal{S}_f^n\phi^{(k)}\right\|_p + \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi^{(k)} - \tilde{\phi}^{(k)}\right\|_p + \left\|\tilde{\phi}^{(k)} - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_p \\ &\leqslant \frac{\varepsilon}{3} + \frac{\varepsilon}{3} + \frac{\varepsilon}{3} = \varepsilon,\end{aligned}$$

for n large enough.

Finally, in order to prove that $\int_x \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu = \int_X \tilde{\phi} \, \mathrm{d}\mu$, it is enough to notice that if $\phi \in L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, then $\phi \in L^1(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and it holds

$$\begin{aligned}\left|\int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu - \int_X \tilde{\phi} \, \mathrm{d}\mu\right| &= \left|\int_X \mathcal{S}_f^n\phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu - \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu\right| \\ &\leqslant \int_X \left|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi - \tilde{\phi}\right| \, \mathrm{d}\mu = \left\|\mathcal{S}_f^n\phi - \tilde{\phi}\right\|_1 \to 0,\end{aligned}$$

as $n \to +\infty$. □

Exercise 7.8. Show that Corollary 7.13 is false for $p = \infty$.

Corollary 7.14 (Birkhoff theorem for continuous functions)**.** Let X be compact metric space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a continuous map. Then there exists a Borel subset $X' \subset X$ such that $\mu(X') = 1$, for every $\mu \in \mathfrak{M}(f)$ and the following limit exists for every $x \in X'$ and every $\phi \in C^0(X, \mathbb{R})$:

$$\tilde{\phi}(x) := \lim_{n \to +\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big).$$

Proof. Since X is compact, the Banach space $C^0(X, \mathbb{R})$ is separable, i.e. there exists a sequence $(\phi_k)_{k \geqslant 1}$ which is dense in $C^0(X, \mathbb{R})$. For each $k \in \mathbb{N}$ we define

$$X_k := \left\{ x \in X : \lim_{n \to +\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi_k\big(f^j(x)\big) \text{ exists} \right\}.$$

The set X_k is clearly a Borel set and, by Birkhoff theorem (Theorem 7.7) we know that $\mu(X_k) = 1$, for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$ and all $\mu \in \mathfrak{M}(f)$. So, if we define

$$X' := \bigcap_{k \in \mathbb{N}} X_k,$$

it clearly holds $\mu(X') = 1$, for every $\mu \in \mathfrak{M}(X)$.

Then, let us consider an arbitrary point $x \in X'$ and a positive real number $\varepsilon > 0$. Given any $\phi \in C^0(X, \mathbb{R})$, by denseness of the sequence (ϕ_k) we know there exists $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\|\phi - \phi_k\|_0 < \varepsilon/2$. So we have

$$\begin{aligned}
0 &\leqslant \limsup_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big) - \liminf_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big) \\
&\leqslant \left| \limsup_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big) - \limsup_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi_k\big(f^j(x)\big) \right| \\
&\qquad + \left| \liminf_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi_k\big(f^j(x)\big) - \liminf_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^j(x)\big) \right| \\
&< \frac{\varepsilon}{2} + \frac{\varepsilon}{2} = \varepsilon.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the $lim_n \frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \phi(f^j(x))$ exists and the result is proved. □

7.6 Some important exercises from [VO16, §3.2.4]

3.2.3, 3.2.4, 3.2.5.

8 Ergodicity

Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map. We say that (f, μ) is **ergodic** when given any $A \in \mathscr{B}$ such that $f^{-1}(A) = A$, either $\mu(A) = 0$ or $\mu(A) = 1$.

Ergodic systems satisfy the following properties:

Theorem 8.1. Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map. Then the following statements are equivalent:

1. (f, μ) is ergodic;
2. given any $B \in \mathscr{B}$ such that $\mu\big(B \triangle f^{-1}(B)\big) = 0$, then $\mu(B) \in \{0, 1\}$;
3. if $\phi \in X \to \mathbb{R}$ is a measurable function such that
$$\phi\big(f(x)\big) = \phi(x), \quad \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x \in X,$$
then there exists $c \in \mathbb{R}$ such that $\phi(x) = c$, for μ-a.e. $x \in X$;
4. for every $A, B \in \mathscr{B}$ it holds
$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \mu\big(f^{-j}(A) \cap B\big) \to \mu(A)\mu(B),$$
as $n \to +\infty$;
5. given $p, q \in (1, \infty)$ such that $\dfrac{1}{p} + \dfrac{1}{q} = 1$, and $\phi \in L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and $\psi \in L^q(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, it holds
$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \int_X (\phi \circ f^j)\psi \, \mathrm{d}\mu \to \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu \int_X \psi \, \mathrm{d}\mu,$$
as $n \to +\infty$.

Exercise 8.1. Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be measure preserving map. Let $B \in \mathscr{B}$ be a measurable set such that $\mu\big(B \triangle f^{-1}(B)\big) = 0$. Show that there exists $A \in \mathscr{B}$ satisfying $f^{-1}(A) = A$ and $\mu(A \triangle B) = 0$.

Proof of Theorem 8.1. Clearly *(2)* implies *(1)*. On the other hand, by Exercise 8.1 we know that *(1)* implies *(2)*.

If (f, μ) is not ergodic, then there exists $A \in \mathscr{B}$ with $f^{-1}(A) = A$ and $0 < \mu(A) < 1$. Then, $\mathbb{1}_A \circ f = \mathbb{1}_{f^{-1}(A)} = \mathbb{1}_A$ and $\mathbb{1}_A$ is not constant μ-a.e. So, *(3)* implies *(1)*. On the other hand, if $\phi\big(f(x)\big) = \phi(x)$ for μ-a.e. point $x \in X$ and ϕ is not constant μ-almost everywhere, then there exists $r \in \mathbb{R}$ such that $B := \phi^{-1}[-\infty, r]$ satisfies $0 < \mu(B) < 1$, with $\mu\big(B \triangle f^{-1}(B)\big) = 0$. Thus, *(2)* implies *(3)*.

Then, if *(4)* holds and $A \in \mathscr{B}$ is f-invariant, then we have

$$\mu(A) = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \mu\big(A \cap f^{-1}(A)\big) \to \mu(A)^2, \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty.$$

So $\mu(A) \in \{0,1\}$ and *(1)* holds.

On the other hand, assuming *(5)* we can easily prove *(4)* taking $\phi := \mathbb{1}_A$ and $\psi := \mathbb{1}_B$.

Finally, let us prove that *(1)* implies *(5)*. To do that, let us star assuming $\phi \in L^\infty(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and $\psi \in L^q(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$. Then, by Birkhoff ergodic theorem (Theorem 7.7), and since *(1)* implies *(3)*, we know that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^i(x)\big) \to \int_X \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu, \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty,$$

and for μ-a.e. $x \in X$, and we have

$$\left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(f^i(x)\big)\psi(x)\right| \leqslant \|\phi\|_\infty |\psi(x)|, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N},$$

where $|\psi|$ is an integrable function. So, by dominated converge theorem we conclude that

$$\lim_{n\to+\infty} \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \int_x (\phi \circ f^i)\psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu = \left(\int_x \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right)\left(\int_X \psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right),$$

we wanted to prove. The general case, where $\phi \in L^p(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ can be proved taking the sequence of truncations of ϕ given by $\phi_k := \mathbb{1}_{[|\phi|\leqslant k]}\phi \in L^\infty(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Then we have $\phi_k \to \phi$ in L^p and μ-almost everywhere. Then, given any $\varepsilon > 0$ there is $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\|\phi - \phi_k\|_p < \varepsilon$ and, by the previous argument, there is $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$\left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \int_X (\phi \circ f^i)\psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu - \int_X \psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu \int_X \psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right| < \varepsilon, \quad \forall n \geqslant N.$$

Hence we have

$$\begin{aligned}
&\left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \int_X (\phi \circ f^i)\psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu - \int_X \phi \,\mathrm{d}\mu \int_X \psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right| \\
&\leqslant \left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \int_X \big((\phi - \phi_k) \circ f^i\big)\psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right| + \left|\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \int_X (\phi_k \circ f^i)\psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu - \int_X \phi_k \,\mathrm{d}\mu \int_X \psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right| \\
&\qquad + \left|\int_X (\phi_k - \phi) \,\mathrm{d}\mu \int_X \psi \,\mathrm{d}\mu\right| \leqslant \|\phi - \phi_k\|_p \|\psi\|_q + \varepsilon + \|\phi_k - \phi\|_1 \|\psi\|_1 \\
&\leqslant \varepsilon \|\psi\|_q + \varepsilon + \|\phi_k - \phi\|_p \|\psi\|_q \leqslant \varepsilon\big(2\|\psi\|_q + 1\big),
\end{aligned}$$

for every $n \geqslant N$. □

We shall need a little improvement of condition *(3)* of Theorem 8.1:

Exercise 8.2. Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map, and let $\mathcal{A} \subset 2^X$ be an algebra such that $\mathscr{B}$ is the σ-algebra generated by $\mathcal{A}$ and suppose that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \mu\big(f^{-i}(A) \cap B\big) \to \mu(A)\mu(B), \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty,$$

for every $A, B \in \mathcal{A}$. Then, show that (f, μ) is ergodic.

8.1 Examples of ergodic systems

8.1.1 Circle rotations

Given any $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, we define the rotation $T_\alpha\colon \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ by

$$T_\alpha(x + \mathbb{Z}) := x + \alpha + \mathbb{Z}, \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Since $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ is a compact group, its Haar measure λ is T_α-invariant for every $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$.

Exercise 8.3. Let $\pi\colon \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ be a the natural quotient map, i.e. $\pi(x) := x + \mathbb{Z}$, for every $x \in \mathbb{R}$. Show that $\lambda = \pi_\star\left(\mathrm{Leb}\big|_{[0,1]}\right)$.

Exercise 8.4. Given $\alpha \in \mathbb{Q}$, show that (T_α, λ) is not ergodic.

Theorem 8.2. The system (T_α, λ) is ergodic for every $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}\backslash\mathbb{Q}$.

Proof of Theorem 8.2. Let $\phi \in L^2(\mathbb{T}, \lambda)$ be a T_α-invariant function, i.e. $\phi(T_\alpha(x)) = \phi(x)$, for λ-a.e. $x \in \mathbb{T}$. Considering the Fourier series of ϕ and $\phi \circ T_\alpha$, we get

$$\phi(T_\alpha(x)) = \sum_{k\in\mathbb{Z}} \hat{\phi}_k e^{2\pi i k(x+\alpha)} = \sum_{k\in\mathbb{Z}} \hat{\phi}_k e^{2\pi i k x} = \phi(x),$$

for λ-a.e. $x \in \mathbb{T}$.

That means that

$$\hat{\phi}_k e^{2\pi i k\alpha} = \hat{\phi}_k, \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{Z},$$

and since $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}\backslash\mathbb{Q}$, we get that $k\alpha \in \mathbb{Z}$ if and only if $k = 0$. So, $\hat{\phi}_k = 0$ for every $k \in \mathbb{Z}\backslash\{0\}$ and we conclude, ϕ is a constant function. □

8.1.2 Expanding maps on the interval

Given any $k \in \mathbb{N}$ with $k \geqslant 2$, consider the map $f\colon [0,1] \circlearrowleft$ given by

$$f(x) := kx - \lfloor kx \rfloor, \quad \forall x \in [0,1].$$

We have shown in §4.2 that the measure $\lambda := \mathrm{Leb}\big|_{[0,1]}$ is f-invariant. Moreover, we have

Theorem 8.3. The system (f, λ) is ergodic.

In order to prove Theorem 8.3, we shall need the following classical result due to Lebesgue:

Theorem 8.4 (Lebesgue density theorem)**.** Let $A \subset \mathbb{R}$ be a measurable set and λ denote the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{R}$. Consider the function $D_A \colon A \times (0, +\infty) \to \mathbb{R}$ given by

$$D_A(x, r) := \inf \left\{ \frac{\lambda(I \cap A)}{\lambda(I)} : I \text{ is an open interval }, \ x \in I \subset B_r(x) \right\},$$

for all $x \in A$ and every $r > 0$.
If $\lambda(A) > 0$, then it holds

$$\lim_{r \downarrow 0} D_A(x, r) = 1, \quad \text{for } \mu\text{-a.e. } x \in A. \tag{15}$$

A point $x \in A$ where condition (15) holds, is called a *Lebesgue density point of* A.

Proof of Theorem 8.3. Let $A \subset [0, 1]$ be a measurable set such that $f^{-1}(A) = A$. Let us suppose that $\lambda(A) > 0$. We want to prove that $\lambda(A) = 1$. To do that, let $\varepsilon > 0$ denote an arbitrary small positive number. We shall prove that $\lambda(A) > 1 - \varepsilon$.

By Theorem 8.4, there exists a Lebesgue density point $x \in A$. For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $i \in \{1, 2 \ldots, k^n\}$, consider the interval

$$I_n^i := \left(\frac{i-1}{k^n}, \frac{i}{k^n} \right).$$

Since x is a Lebesgue density point of A, there exists $r \in (0, k^{-3})$ such that $D_A(x, r) > 1 - \varepsilon$. On the other hand, there is $n > 3$ and $i \in \{1, \ldots, k^n\}$ such that $x \in I_n^i \subset B_r(x)$. So, we get

$$\frac{\lambda(I_n^i \cap A)}{\lambda(I_n^i)} \geqslant D_A(x, r) > 1 - \varepsilon.$$

Now, observe that $f^n\big|_{I_n^i} \to (0, 1)$ is an affine diffeomorphism. In particular, this implies that

$$1 - \varepsilon < \frac{\lambda(I_n^i \cap A)}{\lambda(I_n^k)} = \frac{\lambda(f^n(I_n^i \cap A))}{\lambda(f^n(I_n^i))} = \lambda(f^n(I_n^i \cap A)) \leqslant \lambda(A),$$

where the first equality follows from the fact that f^n is an affine diffeomorphism on I_n^i and the last inequality follows from the fact that $f^{-1}(A) = A$. Since $\varepsilon > 0$ was arbitrary, we conclude that $\lambda(A) = 1$. □

8.1.3 Bernoulli shifts

Given any $k \in \mathbb{N}$ with $k \geqslant 2$ and an stochastic vector $\boldsymbol{p} = (p_1, \ldots, p_k) \in \mathbb{R}^k$ with $p_i > 0$ and $\sum_{i=1}^k p_i = 1$, we consider the full shift map $f \colon \Sigma_k^+ \circlearrowleft$ and the Bernoulli measure μ on Σ_k^+ as defined in §8.1.3.

We shall prove the following result:

Theorem 8.5. The system (f, μ) is ergodic.

Proof. Invoking Exercise 8.2, it is enough to prove that for every cylinder sets $C_1, C_2 \subset \Sigma_k^+$ it holds

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \mu\big(f^{-j}(C_1) \cap C_2\big) \to \mu(C_1)\mu(C_2), \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty,$$

where the definition of cylinder set is given by (7).

In order to prove that the above limit holds, let us introduce the following notation: given any $n \in \mathbb{N}$, a subset $A \subset \mathbb{N}_0$ and function $I \in \{1, \dots, k\}^A$, let us write

$$A + n := \{m + n : m \in A\},$$

and $I^n \colon A + n \to \{1, \dots, k\}$ given by $I^n(m + n) := I(m)$, for every $m \in A$.

Then, given two finite non-empty sets $A_1, A_2 \subset \mathbb{N}_0$ and arbitrary functions $I_i \in \{1, \dots, k\}^{A_i}$, for $i = 1, 2$, one can easily check that

$$f^{-n}[A_i; I_i] = [A_i + n; I_i^n], \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{N}_0,$$

and $i = 1, 2$.

From this, we get that given cylinder sets $C_1 = [A_1; I_1]$ and $C_2 = [A_2; I_2]$, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ satisfying $n > \max_{m \in A_2} m$, it holds

$$f^{-n}(C_1) \cap C_2 = [A_1 + n \sqcup A_2; I_1^n \cup I_2],$$

where given two functions $h_i \colon X_i \to Y$, for $i = 1, 2$ such that $X_1 \cap X_2 = \varnothing$, we are writing $h_1 \cup h_2 \colon X_1 \sqcup X_2 \to Y$ for the function defined by $(h_1 \cup h_2)(x) := h_i(x)$, for every $x \in X_i$ and $i = 1, 2$.

So, we clearly have

$$\mu\big(f^{-n}(C_1) \cap C_2\big) = \mu\big([A_1 + n \sqcup A_2; I_1^n \cup I_2]\big) = \mu\big([A_1; I_1]\big)\mu\big([A_2; I_2]\big) = \mu(C_1)\mu(C_2),$$

for every $n \in \mathbb{N}_0$ satisfying $n > \max_{m \in A_2} m$. This proves the desired limit and concludes the proof of Theorem 8.5. □

8.2 Some properties of ergodic measures

Let $(X, \mathscr{B})$ be a measurable space and $f \colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measurable map. We first observe that ergodic measures are "minimal elements" with respect to the preorder given by absolute continuity among invariant measures:

Proposition 8.6. If μ and ν are two f-invariant probability measures such that μ is ergodic and $\nu \ll \mu$ (i.e. $\nu(A) = 0$, for every $A \in \mathscr{B}$ such that $\mu(A) = 0$), then $\nu = \mu$.

Proof. Given an arbitrary set $A \in \mathscr{B}$, by Birkhoff ergodic theorem and since μ is ergodic,

we get that there exists a measure $R_A \in \mathscr{B}$ with $\mu(R_A) = 1$ such that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \mathbb{1}_A \circ f^j(x) \to \mu(A), \quad \text{as } n \to +\infty, \ \forall x \in R_A.$$

Since $\nu \ll \mu$ and $\mu(X \backslash R_A) = 0$, we get $\nu(X \backslash R_A) = 0$. So the above Birkhoff averages converge to $\mu(A)$ for ν-a.e. $x \in \mathbb{R}$ and consequently, $\mu(A) = \nu(A)$. Since A was arbitrary, we get $\mu = \nu$. □

We get the following

Corollary 8.7. Let $(X, \mathscr{B})$ be a measurable space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measurable map. If μ denotes an f-invariant probability measure, then μ is not ergodic if and only there exist two f-invariant measures ν_1 and ν_2 with $\nu_1 \neq \nu_2$ and $t \in (0,1)$ such that

$$\mu = t\nu_1 + (1-t)\nu_2.$$

Proof. Let us start assuming μ is not ergodic. Then there is $A \in \mathscr{B}$ with $0 < \mu(A) < 1$. So, let us define $\nu_!(E) := \dfrac{1}{\mu(A)}\mu(A \cap E)$ and $\nu_2 := \dfrac{1}{\mu(X \backslash A)}\mu(E \backslash A)$, for every $E \in \mathscr{B}$, and it clearly holds

$$\mu = \mu(A)\nu_1 + \mu(X \backslash A)\nu_2 = \mu(A)\nu_1 + \big(1 - \mu(A)\big)\nu_2.$$

Reciprocally, let us suppose that μ is ergodic and there are f-invariant measures ν_1 and ν_2 and $t \in (0,1)$ such that $\mu = t\nu_1 + (1-t)\nu_2$. Then it clearly holds $\nu_1 \ll \mu$ and $\nu_2 \ll \mu$. By Proposition 8.6, we know that $\mu = \nu_1 = \nu_2$. □

8.3 Some important exercises from [VO16, §4.1.3]

4.1.1, 4.1.2, 4.1.3, 4.1.4, 4.1.5, 4.1.7.

8.4 Some important exercises from [VO16, §4.2.7]

4.2.4, 4.2.5, 4.2.6 (be careful!), 4.2.8, 4.2.11, 4.2.12.

9 Unique ergodicity

Given a measurable space $(X, \mathscr{B})$ and a measurable map $f\colon (X, \mathscr{B}) \circlearrowleft$, we say that f is **uniquely ergodic** if there exists a unique f-invariant probability measure μ on $(X, \mathscr{B})$. In general, when we study unique ergodicity, we restrict our attention to the case where X is a compact metric space and $\mathscr{B}$ is its Borel σ-algebra. Observe that when f is uniquely ergodic, the unique f-invariant probability measure μ is necessarily ergodic.

In this case, we can use the following equivalent definition of unique ergodicity:

Theorem 9.1. If X denotes a compact metric space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ is a continuous map, then f the following are equivalent:

1. f is uniquely ergodic.
2. For every continuous function $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$, there is a constant $c_\phi \in \mathbb{R}$ such that
$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \phi(f^k(x)) = c_\phi, \quad \forall x \in X.$$
3. For every continuous function $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$, there is a constant $c_\phi \in \mathbb{R}$ such that
$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \phi \circ f^k \to c_\phi, \quad \text{uniformly on } X,$$
as $n \to \infty$.
4. There is a Borel probability measure μ on X such that
$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \delta_{f^k(x)} \rightharpoonup \mu, \quad \text{weak-}\star \text{ as } n \to \infty, \quad \forall x \in X.$$

Proof. Let us start showing that (1) implies (2). Let μ denote the unique f-invariant probability measure on X. For every continuous function $\phi\colon X \to \mathbb{R}$, we define the constant $c_\phi = \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu$. Suppose there is $x \in X$ such that

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \phi(f^i(x)) \neq c_\phi.$$

Then, there exist $\varepsilon > 0$ and a subsequence $(n_k)_{k\in\mathbb{N}}$ with $n_k \to +\infty$, as $k \to \infty$, such that

$$\left| \frac{1}{n_k} \sum_{i=0}^{n_k} \phi(f^i(x)) - \int_X \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu \right| > \varepsilon, \quad \forall k \in \mathbb{N}. \tag{16}$$

Since X is compact, the space of Borel probability measures on X is compact in the weak-$\star$ topology. Therefore, there exists a subsequence $(n_{k_j})_{j\in\mathbb{N}}$ such that

$$\frac{1}{n_{k_j}} \sum_{i=0}^{n_{k_j}} \delta_{f^i(x)} \rightharpoonup \nu, \quad \text{weak-}\star \text{ as } j \to \infty.$$

By (16), we have that $\nu \neq \mu$, which contradicts the unique ergodicity of f.

Clearly, (2) implies (3), and (3) implies (4).

Finally, let us show that (4) implies (1). Let μ denote the Borel probability measure on X such that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{k=0}^{n-1}\delta_{f^k(x)} \rightharpoonup \mu, \quad \text{weak-}\star \text{ as } n \to \infty, \quad \forall x \in X.$$

Let ν be an f-invariant probability measure on X. By Birkhoff's ergodic theorem, for ν-almost every $x \in X$, we have that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{k=0}^{n-1}\delta_{f^k(x)} \rightharpoonup \nu, \quad \text{weak-}\star \text{ as } n \to \infty.$$

So, ν must coincide with μ, which proves that f is uniquely ergodic. □

9.1 Examples of uniquely ergodic systems

Theorem 9.2. Let $(G,+)$ be a compact abelian group and, for each $a \in G$, let $T_a\colon G \circlearrowleft$ be the translation map defined by $T_a(x) = x + a$, for every $x \in G$. Let λ denote the Haar measure on G.
Then, the following statements are equivalent:

1. T_a is topologically transitive, i.e. there exists $x \in G$ such that the orbit $\{T_a^n(x)\colon n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is dense in G.
2. T_a is minimal, i.e., for every $x \in G$, the orbit $\{T_a^n(x)\colon n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is dense in G.
3. T_a is uniquely ergodic.
4. λ is an ergodic measure for T_a.

Proof of Theorem 9.2. Let us start showing there exists a distance $d\colon G \to G \to [0,1]$ that is invariant under translations, i.e. $d(x+a, y+a) = d(x,y)$, for every $x, y, a \in G$. Let $d_0\colon G \to G \to [0,1]$ be any distance that induces the topology of G. Then, we define

$$d(x,y) = \int_G d_0(x+z, y+z)\,\mathrm{d}\lambda(z), \quad \forall x, y \in G.$$

It is easy to see that d is a distance that induces the topology of G and is invariant under translations.

Then, let us show that (1) implies (2). Let $x \in G$ be such that the orbit $\{T_a^n(x)\colon n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is dense in G. Given arbitrary points $y, z \in G$ and any $\varepsilon > 0$, we need to show that there is $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $d(T_a^n(y), z) < \varepsilon$. Since the orbit of x is dense in G, there exists $n_1, n_2 \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $d(T_a^{n_1}(x), z) < \varepsilon/2$ and $d(T_a^{n_2}(x), y) < \varepsilon/2$. Since d is invariant under translations, we have that

$$\begin{aligned} d\big(T_a^{n_1-n_2}(y), z\big) &\leqslant d\Big(T_a^{n_1-n_2}(y), T_a^{n_1-n_2}\big(T_a^{n_2}(x)\big)\Big) + d\Big(T_a^{n_1-n_2}\big(T_a^{n_2}(x)\big), z\Big) \\ &= d\Big(y, T_a^{n_2}(x)\Big) + d\Big(T_a^{n_1}(x), z\Big) < \varepsilon/2 + \varepsilon/2 = \varepsilon. \end{aligned}$$

Let us show that (2) implies (3). Let μ denote a T_a-invariant probability measure on G. Given an arbitrary point $b \in G$, since T_a is minimal, there is sequence $(n_i)_{i\geqslant 1}$ of natural numbers, such that $T_a^{n_i}(0) = n_i a \to b$, as $i \to \infty$. So, given an arbitrary continuous function $\phi\colon G \to \mathbb{R}$, the function $\phi \circ T_a^{n_i} \to \phi \circ T_b$, as $i \to \infty$, uniformly on G. Therefore, sinc μ is T_a-invariant, it holds

$$\int_G \phi \, \mathrm{d}\mu = \int_G \phi \circ T_a^{n_i} \, \mathrm{d}\mu \to \int_G \phi \circ T_b \, \mathrm{d}\mu, \quad \text{as } i \to \infty.$$

Since ϕ is an arbitrary continuous function, we conclude that μ is T_b-invariant, and since $b \in G$ is an arbitrary point, we conclude that μ is invariant under all translations. Therefore, by the uniqueness of the Haar measure, we conclude that $\mu = \lambda$, which proves that T_a is uniquely ergodic.

The fact that (3) implies (4) is a direct consequence of the fact that the unique T_a-invariant probability measure is necessarily ergodic.

Finally, to prove that (4) implies (1), since λ is an ergodic measure for T_a, by Birkhoff's ergodic theorem for continuous functions (Corollary 7.14), there exists a point $x \in G$ such that

$$\frac{1}{n}\sum_{k=0}^{n-1} \phi\big(T_a^k(x)\big) \to \int_G \phi \, \mathrm{d}\lambda, \quad \text{as } n \to \infty,$$

for every $\phi \in C^0(G, \mathbb{R})$. On the other hand, since λ has total support, i.e. $\lambda(U) > 0$ for every non-empty open set $U \subset G$, we conclude that the orbit $\{T_a^n(x)\colon n \in \mathbb{N}\}$ is dense in G, which proves that T_a is topologically transitive. □

Corollary 9.3. Let $\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ be an irrational number and let $R_\alpha\colon \mathbb{T} \circlearrowleft$ be the rotation map defined by $R_\alpha(x) = x + \alpha$, for every $x \in \mathbb{T}$. Then, R_α is uniquely ergodic.

Proof of Corollary 9.3. Of course, we can show that R_α is uniquely ergodic showing that it is minimal and, then, invoking Theorem 9.2. However, we are going to prove it with a different approach.

For each $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, consider the function $e_n \in C^\infty(\mathbb{T}, \mathbb{C})$ given by $e_n(x) = \exp(2\pi i n x)$. Given an arbitrary Borel probability measure μ on $\mathbb{T}$, we can define its **Fourier coefficients** $(\hat{\mu}_n) \in \mathbb{Z}^{\mathbb{C}}$ by

$$\hat{\mu}_n = \int_{\mathbb{T}} e_{-n} \, \mathrm{d}\mu, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

This map $\mathfrak{M}(\mathbb{T}) \ni \mu \to (\hat{\mu}_n) \in \mathbb{Z}^{\mathbb{C}}$ is indeed injective (see for instance [Kat04, §1.7])

Let μ be an R_α-invariant probability measure on $\mathbb{T}$. Then, for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, we have that

$$\widehat{R_\alpha \mu}_n = \int_{\mathbb{T}} e_{-n}(x+\alpha) \, \mathrm{d}\mu(x) = e^{-2\pi i n \alpha} \int_{\mathbb{T}} e_{-n}(x) \, \mathrm{d}\mu(x) = e^{-2\pi i n \alpha} \hat{\mu}_n,$$

for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Since μ is R_α-invariant, we have that $\widehat{R_\alpha \mu}_n = \hat{\mu}_n$, for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, which implies that

$$\hat{\mu}_n\big(e^{-2\pi i n \alpha} - 1\big) = 0, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

Since α is irrational, we have that $e^{-2\pi i n \alpha} - 1 \neq 0$, for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}\backslash\{0\}$. Therefore, we conclude that $\hat{\mu}_n = 0$, for every $n \in \mathbb{Z}\backslash\{0\}$; and since μ is a probability measure, we have

that $\hat{\mu}_0 = 1$. One can easily check that the Haar measure λ on $\mathbb{T}$ has the same Fourier coefficients, which implies that $\mu = \lambda$. Therefore, R_α is uniquely ergodic. $\square$

10 Ergodic decomposition

10.1 Pushing forward and pulling back σ-algebras

Let us start recalling some notations we introduced in §2.2.

Given two measurable spaces $(X_i, \mathscr{B}_i)$, with $i = 1, 2$, consider a map $f\colon X_1 \to X_2$. One can define the push-forward σ-algebra $f_\star\mathscr{B}_1$ on Y by

$$f_\star\mathscr{B}_1 := \{B \subset X_2 \colon f^{-1}(B) \in \mathscr{B}_1\}.$$

Analogously, we can define the pull-back σ-algebra $f^\star\mathscr{B}_2$ on X by

$$f^\star\mathscr{B}_2 := \{f^{-1}(B) \subset X \colon B \in \mathscr{B}_2\}.$$

One says that the map $f\colon (X_1, \mathscr{B}_1) \to (X_2, \mathscr{B}_2)$ is *measurable* when $\mathscr{B}_2 \subset f_\star\mathscr{B}_1$, or equivalently, when $f^\star\mathscr{B}_2 \subset \mathscr{B}_1$.

When μ is a measure on $(X_1, \mathscr{B}_1)$, one can define the push-forward measure $f_\star\mu$ on $(X_2, \mathscr{B}_2)$ by

$$f_\star\mu(B) := \mu(f^{-1}(B)), \quad \forall B \in \mathscr{B}_2.$$

10.2 Partitions of measure spaces

Given a probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, a *partition* of X is a family $\xi \subset \mathscr{B}$ such that any two different elements of ξ are disjoint and there is $X' \in \mathscr{B}$ with $\mu(X') = 1$ such that

$$X' = \bigsqcup_{C \in \xi} C.$$

Given any $x \in X'$, we shall write $\xi(x)$ to denote the unique element of ξ containing x. The elements of ξ are called *atoms* of the partition. We can define the natural *projection map* $\pi^\xi\colon X \to \xi$ by $\pi^\xi(x) := \xi(x)$ and notice that π^ξ is well defined μ-almost everywhere, i.e. it is just defined on the set X'.

We can use the natural projection map π^ξ to endow the set ξ with a measure space structure. Indeed, we shall always assume the partition ξ as the supporting set of the measure space $(\xi, \mathscr{B}_\xi, \hat{\mu}^\xi)$ where $\mathscr{B}_\xi := \pi^\xi_\star\mathscr{B}$ and $\hat{\mu}^\xi := \pi^\xi_\star\mu$ denote the push-forward σ-algebra of $\mathscr{B}$ and the measure μ by π^ξ, respectively.

The elements of ξ are called **atoms** of ξ.

10.2.1 Order among partitions

Two partitions ξ and η of X are said to be *equivalent* if there is $X'' \in \mathscr{B}$ with $\mu(X'') = 1$ satisfying

$$X'' \subset \bigsqcup_{C \in \xi} C \cap \bigsqcup_{D \in \eta} D,$$

and such that

$$\xi(x) \cap X'' = \eta(x) \cap X'', \quad \forall x \in X''. \tag{17}$$

By some abuse of notation, we shall simply write $\xi = \eta$ to denote that the partitions ξ and η are equivalent.

We can define a partial order relation among partitions of a measure space. Given two partitions ξ, η of the measure space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$, we say that ξ is **finer** than η, or that η is **coarser** that ξ, and we write $\eta \leqslant \xi$, when there is a measurable subset $X'' \subset X$ with $\mu(X'') = 1$, contained in $\bigsqcup_{C\in\xi} C \cap \bigsqcup_{D\in\eta} D$ and such that

$$\xi(x) \cap X'' \subset \eta(x) \cap X'', \quad \forall x \in X''.$$

Exercise 10.1. Show that two partitions ξ and η of the probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ are equivalent if and only if $\xi \leqslant \eta$ and $\eta \leqslant \xi$.

Exercise 10.2. Show that the notions of *infimum* and *supremum* are well defined for countable subsets on the partially order set $(\mathcal{P}_X, \leqslant)$. More precisely, show that given any countable family of partitions $\Xi \subset \mathcal{P}_X$, there exists two partitions $\inf \Xi, \sup \Xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$ such that

$$\eta \leqslant \inf \Xi \leqslant \xi \leqslant \sup \Xi \leqslant \eta', \quad \forall \xi \in \Xi,$$

and every $\eta, \eta' \in \mathcal{P}_X$ such that $\eta \leqslant \xi' \leqslant \eta'$, for every $\xi' \in \mathcal{P}_X$. These partitions $\inf \Xi$ and $\sup \Xi$ are unique up to equivalence of partitions.

We can use the notions of infimum and supremum on $\mathcal{P}_X$ to define the operators $\wedge$ and $\vee$: given any countable (or finite) family $\Xi \subset \mathcal{P}_X$, we define

$$\bigwedge_{\xi\in\Xi} \xi := \sup \{\eta \in \mathcal{P}_X : \eta \leqslant \xi, \ \forall \xi \in \Xi\},$$

and

$$\bigvee_{\xi\in\Xi} \xi := \inf \{\eta \in \mathcal{P}_X : \xi \leqslant \eta, \ \forall \xi \in \Xi\}. \tag{18}$$

10.3 Disintegration of measures

Given a probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ and a partition $\xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$, a **disintegration** of μ with respect to ξ is family $\{\mu_C : C \in \xi\}$ satisfying the following properties:

(i) μ_C is a probability measure on the measurable space $(X, \mathscr{B})$, for every $C \in \xi$;

(ii) $\mu_C(C) = 1$, for $\hat{\mu}^\xi$-almost every atom $C \in \xi$;

(iii) for every $E \in \mathscr{B}$, the map $\xi \ni C \mapsto \mu_C(E) \in [0, 1]$ is $(\mathscr{B}^\xi, \mathscr{B}_\mathbb{R})$-measurable;

(iv) it holds

$$\mu(E) = \int_\xi \mu_C(E) \, \mathrm{d}\hat{\mu}^\xi(C), \quad \forall E \in \mathscr{B}.$$

Let us observe that one can pull back the partition and push forward the disintegration:

Exercise 10.3. Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space, $\xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$ be a partion and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map. Then, show that $f^\star\xi := \{f^{-1}(C) : C \in \xi\}$ is a partition of $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$. On the other hand, if $\{\mu_D : D \in f^\star\xi\}$ is a disintegration of μ with respect to the partition $f^\star\xi$, show that $\{\mu_C := f_\star\mu_{f^{-1}(C)} : C \in \xi\}$ is a disintegration of μ with respect to ξ.

First we shall prove that every partition admits at most one disintegration:

Theorem 10.1 (Uniqueness of disintegrations)**.** If $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is a Borel space (see §2), $\xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$ is a partition, and $\{\mu_C : C \in \xi\}$ and $\{\nu_C : C \in \xi\}$ are two disintegrations of μ with respect to ξ, then it holds

$$\mu_C = \nu_C, \quad \text{for } \hat{\mu}^\xi\text{-a.e. } C \in \xi.$$

Proof. Since $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is a Borel space, there exists a countable algebra $\mathscr{A} \subset \mathscr{B}$ that generates $\mathscr{B}$. For each $A \in \mathscr{A}$, let us consider the sets

$$\mathscr{M}_A := \{C \in \xi : \mu_C(A) < \nu_C(A)\}, \quad \text{and } \mathscr{N}_A := \{C \in \xi : \mu_C(A) > \nu_C(A)\}.$$

Then, since $\{\mu_C : C \in \xi\}$ is a disintegration of μ with respect to ξ, we have

$$\begin{aligned}\mu\big(A \cap \pi^{\xi^{-1}}(\mathscr{M}_A)\big) &= \int_\xi \mu_C\big(A \cap \pi^{\xi^{-1}}(\mathscr{M}_A)\big)\, \mathrm{d}\hat{\mu}^\xi(C) \\ &= \int_{\mathscr{M}_A} \mu_C(A)\, \mathrm{d}\hat{\mu}^\xi(C).\end{aligned}$$

Analogously, one can show that

$$\mu\big(A \cap \pi^{\xi^{-1}}(\mathscr{M}_A)\big) = \int_{\mathscr{M}_A} \nu_C(A)\, \mathrm{d}\hat{\mu}^\xi(C).$$

Since $\mu_C(A) < \nu_C(A)$, for all $C \in \mathscr{M}_A$, we get $\hat{\mu}^\xi(\mathscr{M}_A) = 0$. Analogously, we can show that $\hat{\mu}^\xi(\mathscr{N}_A) = 0$ and hence, $\mu_C = \nu_C$, for $\hat{\mu}^\xi$-almost every $C \in \xi$. □

Theorem 10.1 can be used to show that certain partitions do not admit any disintegration of the measure:

Example 10.1. *Let α be an arbitrary real irrational number and $f\colon \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \circlearrowleft$ be the corresponding rotation $f(x + \mathbb{Z}) := x + \alpha + \mathbb{Z}$, for every $x \in \mathbb{R}$. Let λ denote the Haar measure on the circle $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ and consider the partition ξ of the probability space $(\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}, \mathscr{B}_{\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}}, \lambda)$ given by the orbits of f, i.e. we have*

$$\xi := \{\{f^n(x) \in \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} : n \in \mathbb{Z}\} : x \in \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}\}.$$

Then there is no disintegration of λ with respect to the partion ξ.

Now we can state the main result of this section:

Theorem 10.2 (Ergodic decomposition theorem)**.** Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a Borel space and $f\colon X \circlearrowleft$ be a measure preserving map. Then there exists a unique partition $\xi_f \in \mathcal{P}_X$, called the **ergodic partition of** f, such ξ_f admits a disintegration $\{\mu_C : C \in \xi_f\}$ and the following conditions hold:

1. $f^\star \xi_f = \xi_f$, i.e. $f^{-1}(C) = C$, for $\hat{\mu}^{\xi_f}$-almost every atom $C \in \xi_f$;
2. μ_C is an ergodic f-invariant measure, for $\hat{\mu}^{\xi_f}$-almost every atom $C \in \xi_f$.

The proof of Theorem 10.2 will be postpone and get as a consequence of Rokhlin decomposition theorem.

10.4 Measurable partitions

By Example 10.1 we know that some partitions do not admit disintegrations. In this section we shall characterize the family of partitions admitting disintegrations.

Given a probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ we say that a partition $\xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$ is a **measurable partition** when there exists a sequence $(\xi_n)_{n\geqslant 1} \subset \mathcal{P}_X$ of finite partitions such that

$$\xi = \bigvee_{n\geqslant 1} \xi_n,$$

where the equality is understood in the sense of equivalence of partitions as defined in §10.2 and the operator $\bigvee$ is given by (18)

A partition ξ of the probability space $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is said to be **measurable** when there is a countable family of finite partitions $\{\xi_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}} \subset \mathcal{P}_X$ such that

$$\xi = \bigvee_{n\in\mathbb{N}} \xi_n,$$

Exercise 10.4. Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a probability space, M be separable metric space and $f\colon X \to M$ be a measurable map. Then the partition

$$\xi_f := \left\{f^{-1}(y) : y \in M\right\} \in \mathcal{P}_X$$

is a measurable partition.
Reciprocally, if $\xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$ is a partition, then ξ is a measurable partition if and only if there exists a compact metric space M, a Borel probability measure ν on M and a measure preserving map $f\colon (X, \mathscr{B}, \mu) \to (M, \mathscr{B}_M, \nu)$ such that $\xi = \xi_f$.

Then we have the main result about measurable partitions:

Theorem 10.3 (Rokhlin theorem)**.** Let $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ be a Borel space and $\xi \in \mathcal{P}_X$ be measurable partition. Then there exits a disintegration of μ with respect to ξ.

We postpone the proof of Theorem 10.3. Now we shall prove the Ergodic decomposition theorem assuming Theorem 10.3.

Proof of Theorem 10.2. Since $(X, \mathscr{B}, \mu)$ is a Borel space, there exists a countable algebra $\mathscr{A} \subset \mathscr{B}$ that generates the σ-algebra $\mathscr{B}$. For each $A \in \mathscr{A}$, let us consider the function $\tau_A \colon X \to [0,1]$ given by

$$\tau_A(x) := \lim_{n \to +\infty} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \mathbb{1}_A\big(f^i(x)\big),$$

whenever the limit exists. By Birkhoff ergodic theorem we know that τ_A is well defined μ-almost everywhere.

Since $\mathscr{A}$ is countable, we get the set $X_0 := \{x \in X : \tau_A(x) \text{ is well defined, } \forall A \in \mathscr{A}\}$ is a measurable set with $\mu(X_0) = 1$.

Then we define the partition $\xi_f \in \mathcal{P}_X$ as the set of equivalence classes on X_0 such that $x \sim y$ if and only if $\tau_A(x) = \tau_A(y)$, for every $A \in \mathscr{A}$.

Exercise 10.5. Show that ξ_f is a measurable partition.

Then, by Rokhlin theorem (Theorem 10.3) we know that there is a disintegration of μ with respect to ξ_f $\{\mu_C : C \in \xi_f\}$.

By the very same definition of functions τ_A we know that $f^{-1}(X_0) = X_0$ and $\tau_A(x) = \tau_A \circ f(x)$, for every $x \in X_0$. So, it clearly holds $f^{-1}(C) = C$, for every $C \in \xi_f$. Thus, by uniqueness of disintegration (Theorem 10.1), we conclude that $f_\star \mu_C = \mu_C$, for $\hat{\mu}^{\xi_f}$-almost every atom $C \in \xi_f$.

So, it just remains to prove that the measure μ_C is ergodic for f, for every atom $C \in \xi_f$. To do that, let us fix an atom $C \in \xi_f$ and observe that to prove the ergodicity of μ_C is enough to show that $\tau_E(x) = \mu_C(E)$, for every $E \in \mathscr{B}$ and μ_C-a.e. $x \in C$. Then, let us define the family

$$\mathscr{B}_C := \{E \in \mathscr{B} : \tau_E(x) = \mu_C(E), \text{ for } \mu_C\text{-a.e. } x \in C\}.$$

By our definition it clearly holds $\mathscr{A} \subset \mathscr{B}_C$. On the other hand, if $E_1, E_2 \in \mathscr{B}_C$, and $E_1 \subset E_2$, then $E_2 \backslash E_1 \in \mathscr{B}_C$ because

$$\tau_{E_2 \backslash E_1}(x) = \tau_{E_2}(x) - \tau_{E_1}(x) = \mu_C(E_2 \backslash E_1),$$

for μ_C-almost every $x \in C$; and if $E_1, E_2, \ldots \in \mathscr{B}_C$ is a family of pairwise disjoint sets, the it clearly holds

$$\tau_{\bigsqcup_j E_j}(x) = \sum_j \tau_{E_j}(x) = \mu_C\left(\bigsqcup_j E_j\right).$$

Then, the ergodicity of μ_C is consequence of the following

Exercise 10.6. A family $\mathcal{C} \subset 2^X$ is called a **monotone class** when given any sequence $A_1 \subset A_2 \subset \ldots$ and $B_1 \supset B_2 \supset \ldots$, with $A_n, B_n \in \mathcal{C}$, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, it holds $\bigcup_n A_n, \bigcap_n B_n \in \mathcal{C}$.
Then, if $\mathcal{C}$ is a monotone class and contains an algebra $\mathscr{A}$, then $\mathcal{C}$ contains the σ-algebra $\sigma(\mathscr{A})$ generated by $\mathscr{A}$.

□

Proof of Theorem 10.3. This elegant proof of is due to Terence Tao and was presented in his blog.

By Exercise 10.4, there exists a compact metric space M, a Borel probability measure ν on M and a measure preserving map $\pi\colon (X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\to(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$ such that $\xi=\xi_\pi$. On the other hand, since we are assuming that $(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ is a Borel space, there is no loss of generality in assuming that X is a compact metric space and $\mathscr{B}$ is its Borel σ-algebra.

Then, we consider the pull-back operator $\pi^*\colon L^2(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)\to L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ given by $\pi^*\phi:=\phi\circ\pi$, for every $\phi\in L^2(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$. So, its (Hilbert) adjoint operator $\pi_*\colon L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\to L^2(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$, by the Riesz representation theorem, is characterized by the following property:

$$\int_M \phi\cdot\pi_*\psi\,\mathrm{d}\nu=\int_X \pi^*\phi\cdot\psi\,\mathrm{d}\mu, \tag{19}$$

for every $\phi\in L^2(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$ and $\psi\in L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$. Since μ and ν are probability measures, we know that $L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)\subset L^2(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ and $L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)\subset L^2(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$. Moreover, as a consequence of (19) and recalling that $\|\pi^*\phi\|_{L^\infty(x,\mathscr{B},\mu)}\leqslant\|\phi\|_{L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)}$, for all $\phi\in L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$, one easily get that

$$\|\pi_*\psi\|_{L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)}\leqslant\|\psi\|_{L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)},\quad\forall\psi\in L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu).$$

Then, since we are assuming that X is a compact metric space, we know that the space of continuous functions $C^0(X)$ is contained and is dense in $L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$. However, $L^\infty(X,\mathscr{B},\mu)$ is a space of equivalence classes of functions, and not just functions. So, we need the following

Lemma 10.4. We write $B(M,\mathscr{B}_M):=\{\phi\colon M\to\mathbb{R}:\phi\text{ is bounded and measurable}\}$. Given any $\phi\in B(M,\mathscr{B}_M)$, we shall temporally write $[\phi]\in L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$ for the equivalence class of ϕ in $L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$. Then, there is a linear operator $\tilde{\pi}_*\colon C^0(X)\to B(M,\mathscr{B}_M)$ and a set $M'\in\mathscr{B}_M$ with $\nu(M')=1$ such that $[\tilde{\pi}_*\psi]=\pi_*\psi\in L^\infty(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)\subset L^2(M,\mathscr{B}_M,\nu)$, for every $\psi\in C^0(X)$, and

$$|\tilde{\pi}_*\psi(y)|\leqslant\|\psi\|_{C^0(X)},\quad\forall y\in M',\ \forall\psi\in C^0(X).$$

Exercise 10.7. Prove Lemma 10.4.

Then, for each $y\in M'$, we define the linear functional $\Lambda_y\colon C^0(X)\to\mathbb{R}$ given by $\Lambda_y(\psi):=\tilde{\pi}_*\psi(y)$, for every $\psi\in C^0(X)$. Observe that Λ_y is a positive bounded linear functional on $C^0(X)$, satisfying $\|\Lambda_y\|\leqslant 1$, for every $y\in M'$. So, by Riesz representation theorem, there exists a unique Borel probability measure μ_y on X such that

$$\Lambda_y(\psi)=\tilde{\pi}_*\psi(y)=\int_X\psi\,\mathrm{d}\mu_y,\quad\forall\psi\in C^0(X).$$

□

10.5 Some important exercises from [VO16, §5.1.5 and §5.2.4]

5.1.1, 5.1.2, 5.1.3, 5.1.6, 5.1.7.

5.2.1.

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